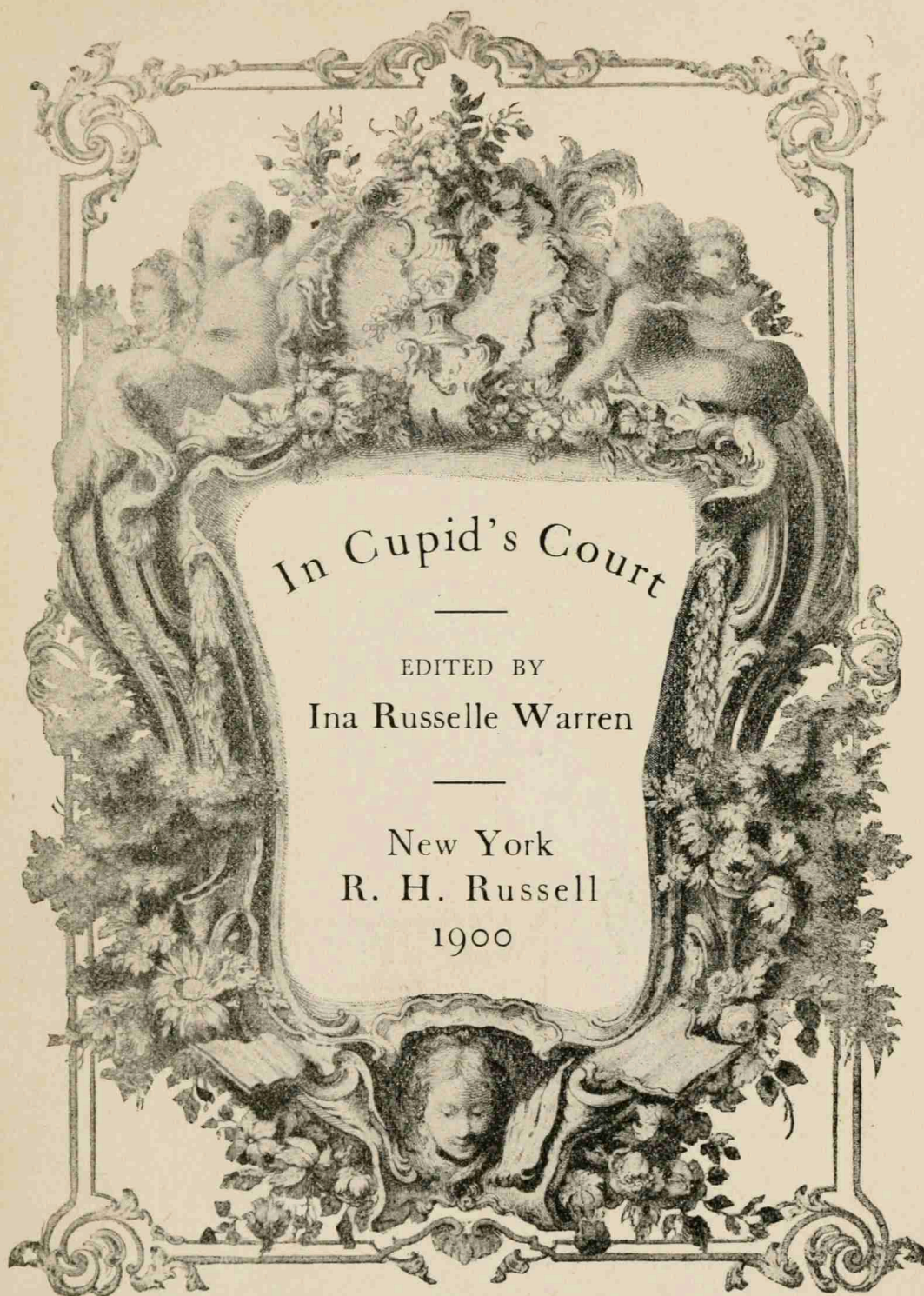


In Cupid's Court

EDITED BY
Ina Russelle Warren

New York
R. H. Russell
1900



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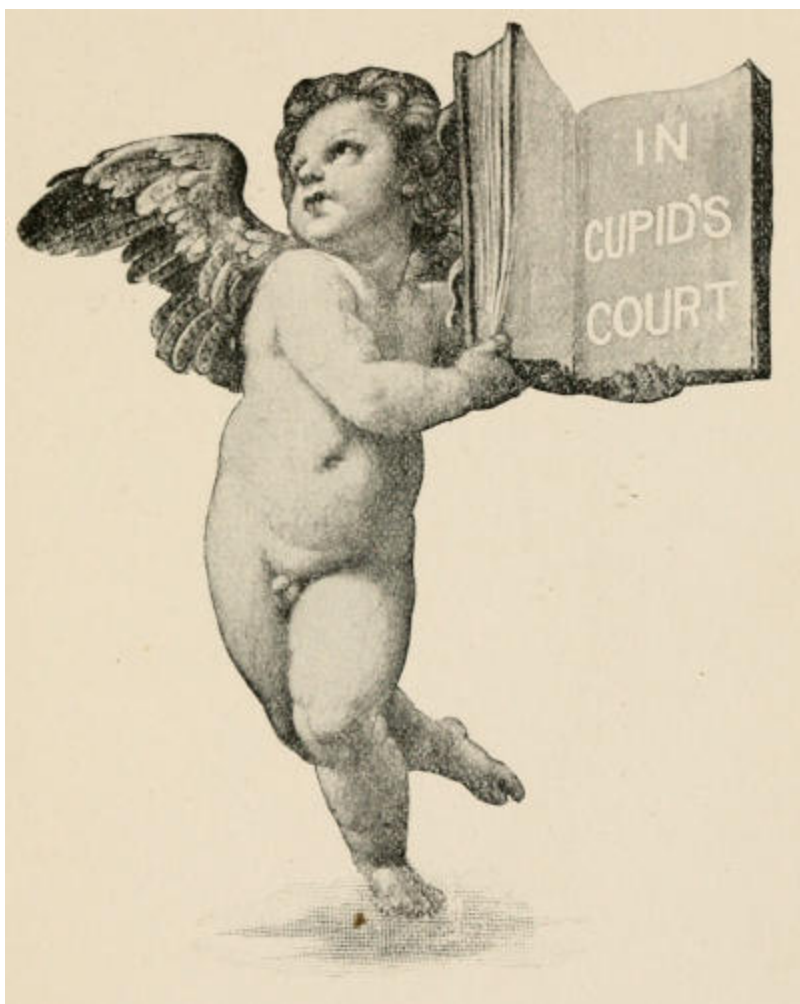
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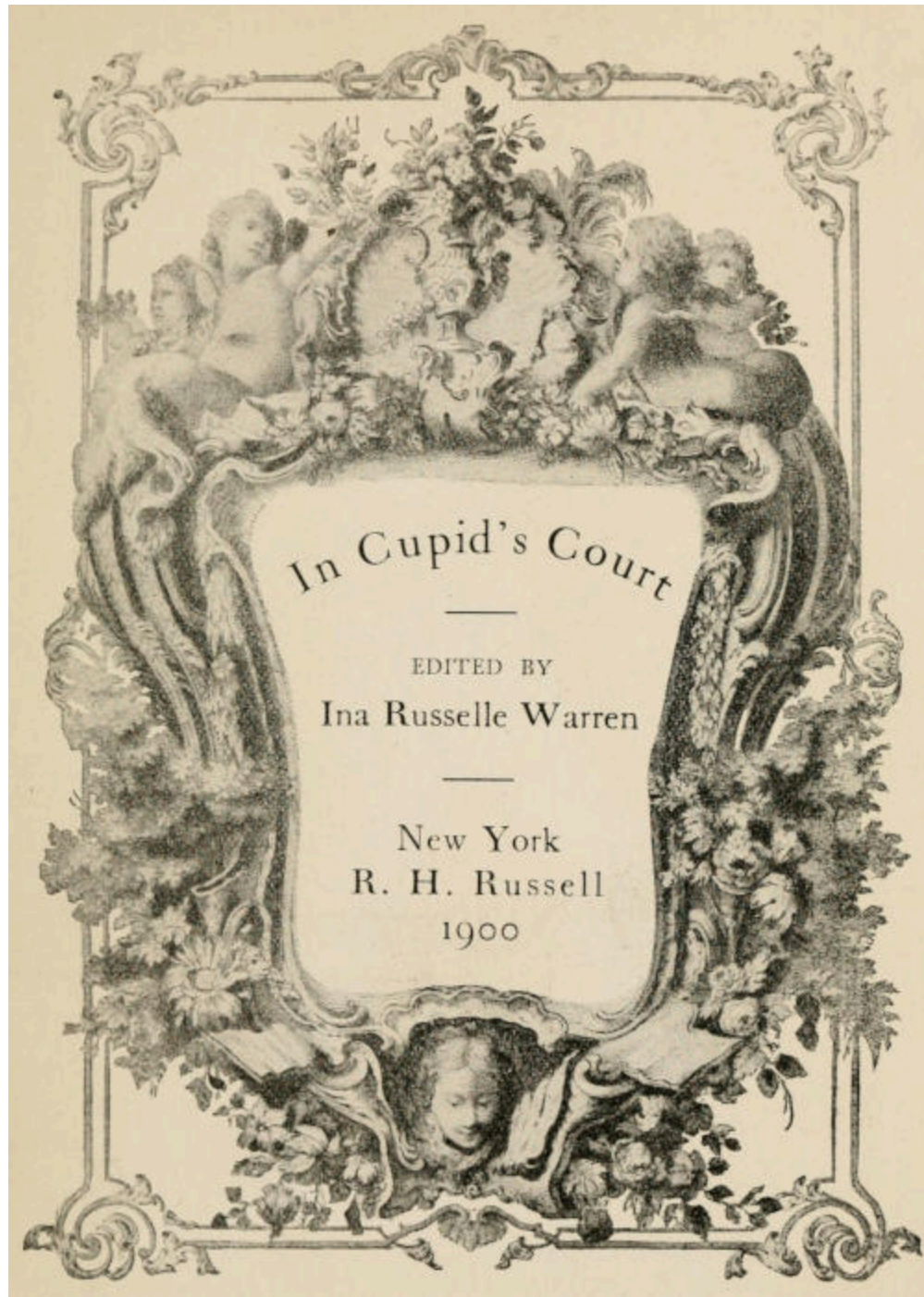
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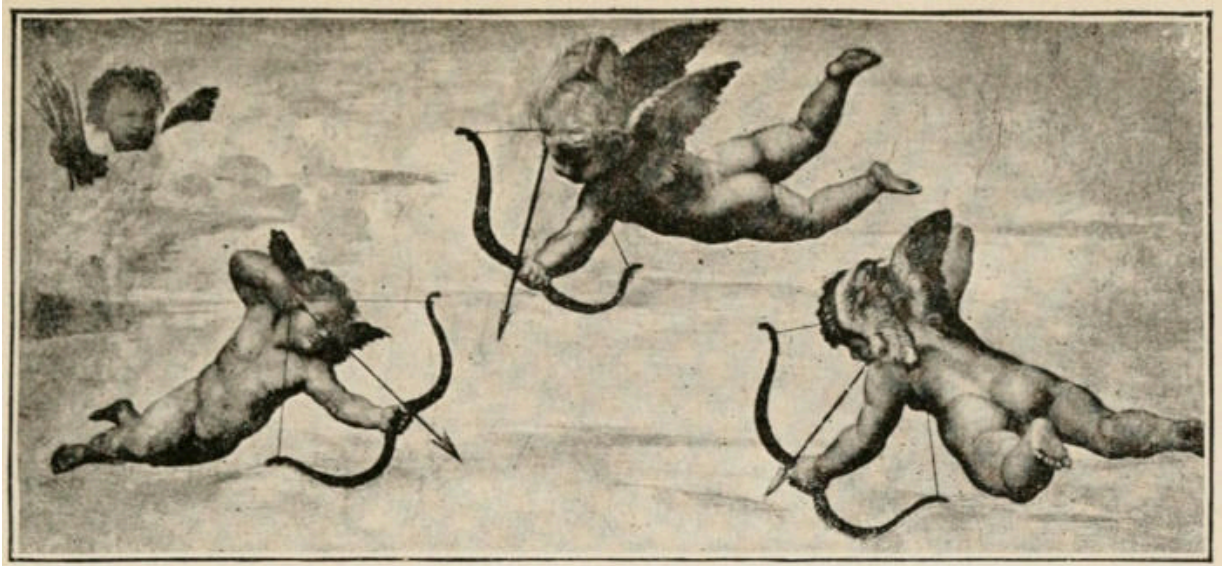
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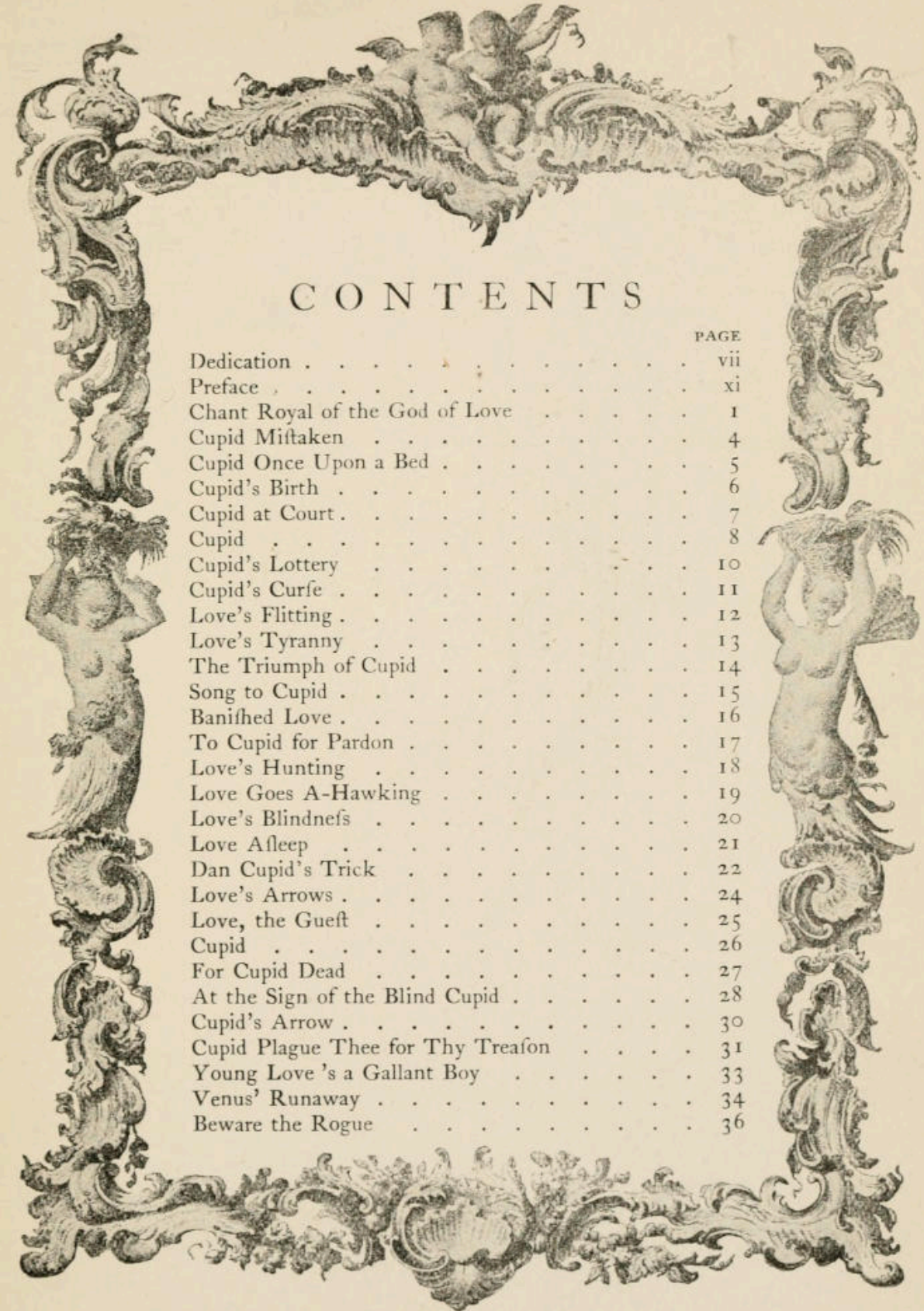
TO T.

*If the world's entirety
Is two eyes that shine on me,
Lay the blame at Love's door, dearest:
Thus he made my world to be.*

*He's the key to Heaven's gate;
He's the scorn that tramples fate;
He's the worth of living, dearest,
He's the laugh that makes Death late.*

*He's the morning sun that wakes us
To the worth of all things, dearest,
He's the influence that makes us
Daily gladder, 'till God takes us!*

TOMAS BEAULING.



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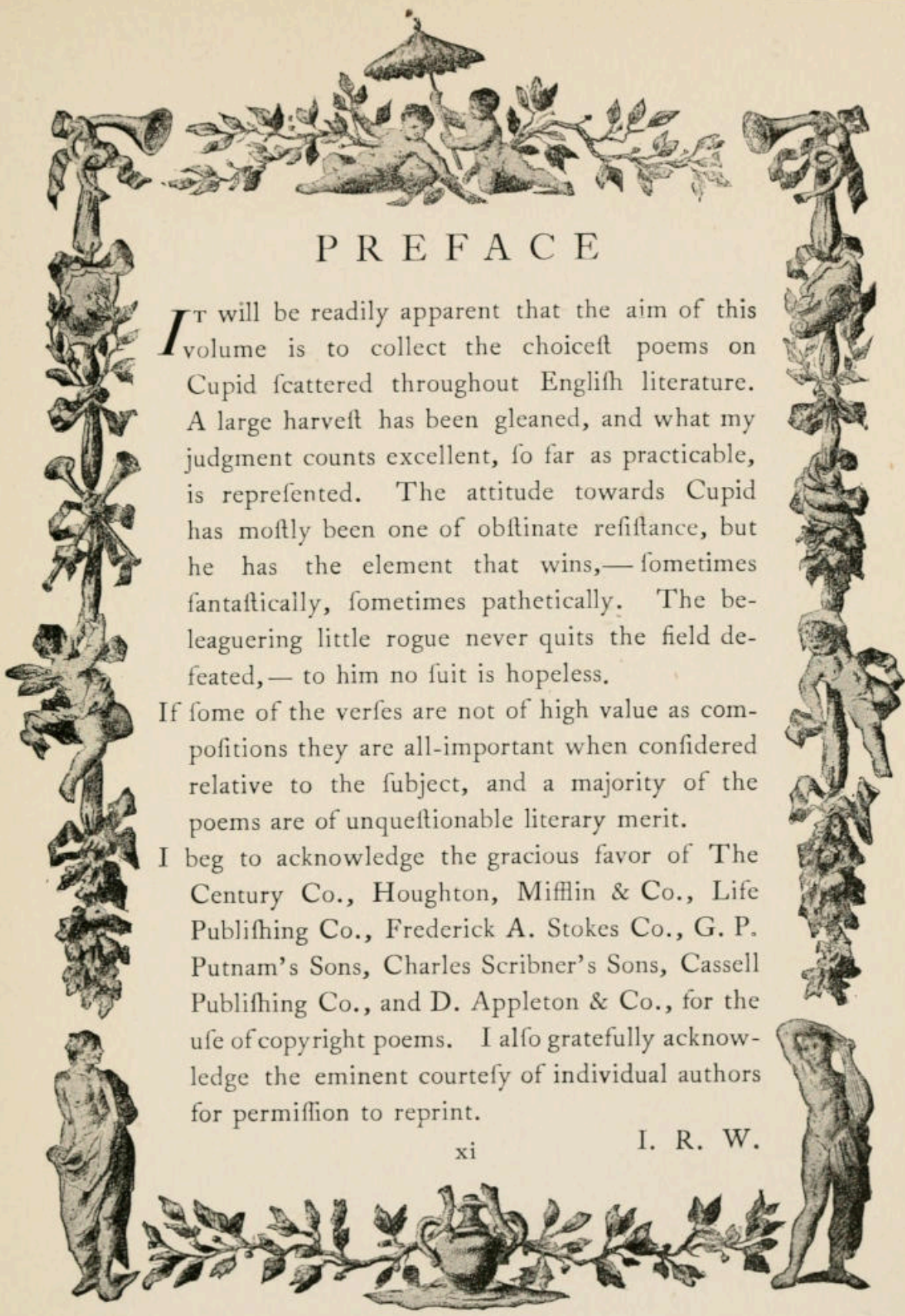
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P R E F A C E

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If some of the verses are not of high value as compositions they are all-important when considered relative to the subject, and a majority of the poems are of unquestionable literary merit.

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I. R. W.

IN CUPID'S COURT



CHANT ROYAL OF THE GOD OF LOVE

O most fair God, O Love both new and old,
That wast before the flowers of morning blew,
Before the glad sun in his mail of gold
Leapt into light across the first day's dew;
That art the first and last of our delight,
That in the blue day and the purple night
Holdest the hearts of servant and of king,
Lord of lisse, sovran of sorrowing,
That in thy hand hast heaven's golden key
And hell beneath the shadow of thy wing,
Thou art my Lord to whom I bend the knee!

What thing rejects thy mastery? Who so bold
But at thine altars in the dusk they sue?
Even the straight pale goddess, silver-stoled,
That kissed Endymion when the spring was new,
To thee did homage in her own despite,
When in the shadow of her wings of white
She slid down trembling from her moonèd ring
To where the Latmian youth lay slumbering,
And in that kiss put off cold chastity.
Who but acclaim with voice and pipe and string,
"Thou art my Lord to whom I bend the knee!"

Master of men and gods, in every fold
Of thy wide vans the sorceries that renew

The labouring earth, tranced with the winter's cold,
Lie hid—the quintessential charms that woo
The souls of flowers, slain with the sullen might
Of the dead year, and draw them to the light.
Balsam and blessing to thy garments cling;
Skyward and seaward, whilst thy white palms fling
Their spells of healing over land and sea,
One shout of homage makes the welkin ring,
“Thou art my Lord to whom I bend the knee!”

I see thee throned aloft; thy fair hands hold
Myrtles for joy, and euphrasy and rue:
Laurels and roses round thy white brows rolled,
And in thine eyes the royal heaven's hue:
But in thy lips' clear colour, ruddy bright,
The heart's blood shines of many a hapless wight.
Thou art not only fair and sweet as Spring;
Terror and beauty, fear and wondering
Meet on thy front, amazing all who see:
All men do praise thee, ay, and everything!
Thou art my Lord to whom I bend the knee!

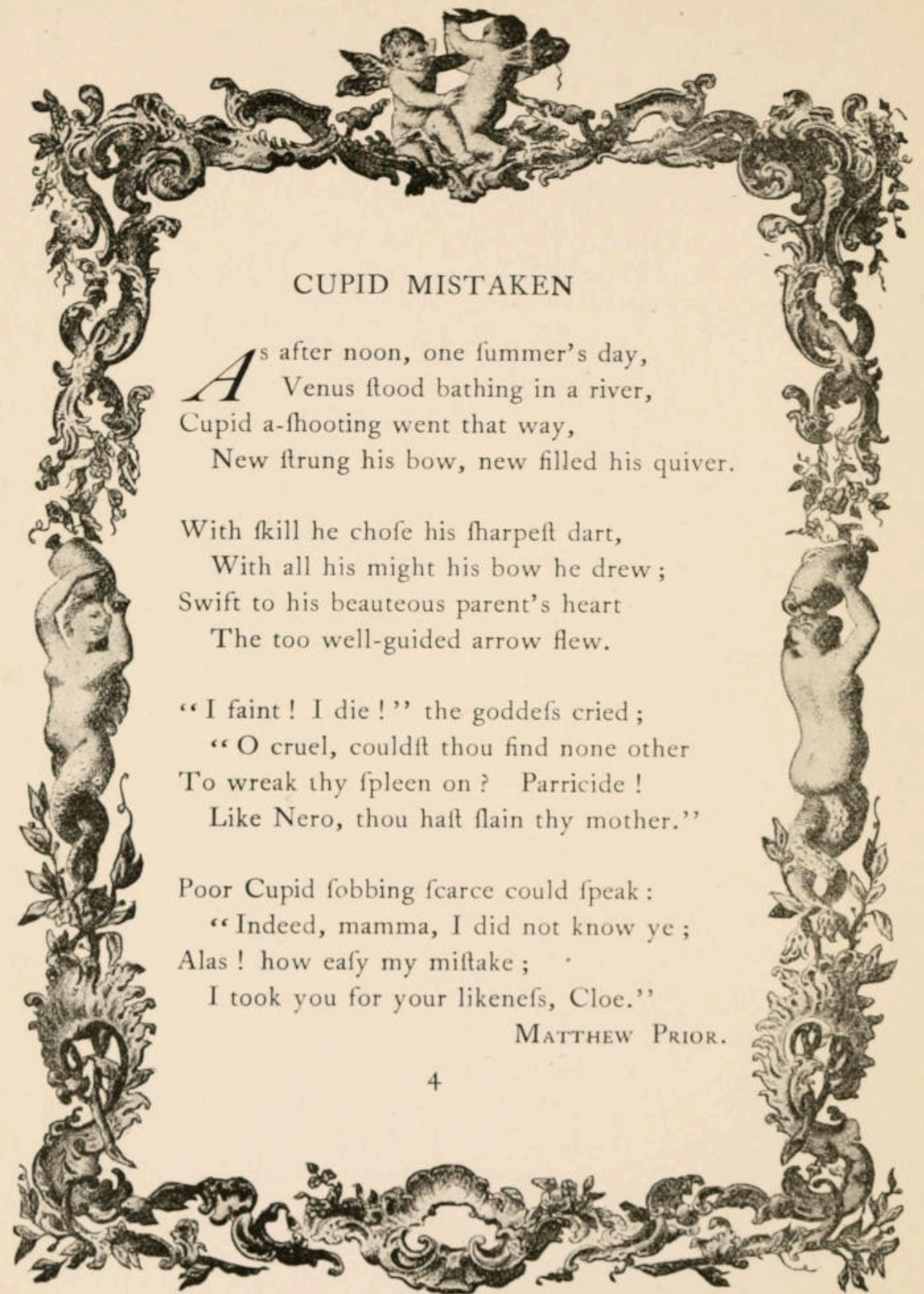
I fear thee, though I love. Who can behold
The sheer sun burning in the orbèd blue,
What while the noontide over hill and wold
Flames like a fire, except his mazèd view
Wither and tremble? So thy splendid sight
Fills me with mingled gladness and affright.
Thy visage haunts me in the wavering
Of dreams, and in the dawn, awakening,
I feel thy splendour streaming full on me.
Both joy and fear unto thy feet I bring;
Thou art my Lord to whom I bend the knee!

ENVOY

*God above Gods, High and Eternal King,
Whose praise, the symphonies of heaven sing,*

*I find no whither from thy power to flee,
Save in thy pinions' vast o'ershadowing:
Thou art my Lord to whom I bend the knee!*

JOHN PAYNE.



CUPID MISTAKEN

*A*s after noon, one summer's day,
Venus stood bathing in a river,
Cupid a-shooting went that way,
New strung his bow, new filled his quiver.

With skill he chose his sharpest dart,
With all his might his bow he drew;
Swift to his beauteous parent's heart
The too well-guided arrow flew.

"I faint! I die!" the goddess cried;
"O cruel, couldst thou find none other
To wreak thy spleen on? Parricide!
Like Nero, thou hast slain thy mother."

Poor Cupid sobbing scarce could speak:
"Indeed, mamma, I did not know ye;
Alas! how easy my mistake;
I took you for your likeness, Cloe."

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CUPID ONCE UPON A BED

CUPID once upon a bed
Of roses laid his weary head ;
Luckless urchin not to see
Within the leaves a slumbering bee !
The bee awaked — with anger wild
The bee awaked and stung the child.
Loud and piteous are his cries ;
To Venus quick he runs, he flies !
“ O mother ! I am wounded through —
I die with pain — in sooth I do !
Stung by some little angry thing,
Some serpent on a tiny wing —
A bee it was — for once, I know,
I heard a rustic call it so.”
Thus he spoke, and she the while
Heard him with a soothing smile ;
Then said, “ My infant, if so much
Thou feel the little wild bee’s touch,
How must the heart, ah, Cupid ! be —
The hapless heart that ’s stung by thee ? ”

THOMAS MOORE.

(Odes of Anacreon.)

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CUPID'S BIRTH

At Cupid's birth, Joy left the bounds of space,
And, heeding not the stars, flew fast to earth,
To hold the hearts of men in warm embrace,
At Cupid's birth.

Then Life, with beaming eyes and quickened pace,
And new-found god-like strength, first knew her worth;
While Fate began the future to retrace.

But Death stood gently by with quiet grace,
Aloof from all the tumult and mad mirth,
A sweet, sad smile lit up his steadfast face
At Cupid's birth.

R. W. BUNNY.

CUPID AT COURT

Young Cupid strung his bow one day,
And sallied out for sport;
As country hearts were easy prey,
Odd Darts! he went to court.

Of all that wore the puff and patch,
Belinda led the fair:
With falbala, and fan to match,
I trow she made him stare!

“Oho!” he cried, and quickly drew
His bow upon the sly;—
But though he pierced her bosom through,
She never breathed a sigh!

This was a turn, beyond a doubt,
That filled him with amaze,
And so he sought his mother out,
With tear-bewildered gaze.

“You silly boy,” Dame Venus said,
“Why did you waste your art?
Go clip your curls and hide your head,—
Belinda *has* no heart!”

SAMUEL MINTURN PECK.

CUPID

*W*HY was Cupid a boy,
And why a boy was he?
He should have been a girl,
For aught that I can see.

For he shoots with his bow,
And the girl shoots with her eye;
And they both are merry and glad,
And laugh when we do cry.

Then to make Cupid a boy
Was surely a woman's plan,
For a boy never learns so much
Till he has become a man:

And then he's so pierced with cares,
And wounded with arrowy smarts,
That the whole business of his life
Is to pick out the heads of the darts.

WILLIAM BLAKE

CUPID

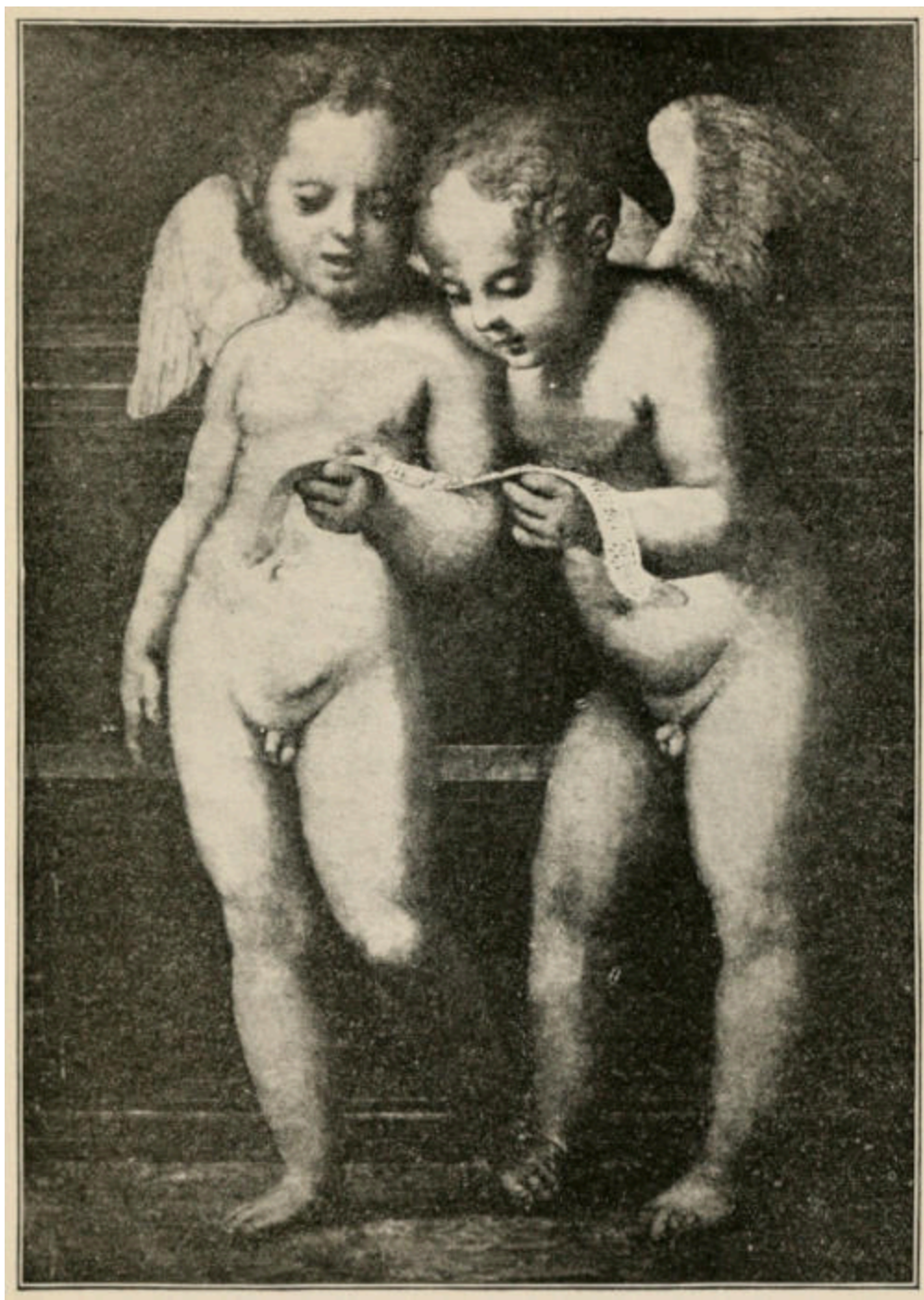
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Is to pick out the heads of the darts.

WILLIAM BLAKE.



CUPID'S LOTTERY

A Lottery, a Lottery,
In Cupid's Court there used to be;
 Two roguish eyes
 The highest prize
In Cupid's scheming Lottery;
 And kisses, too,
 As good as new,
Which weren't very hard to win,
 For he who won
 The eyes of fun
Was sure to have the kisses in.
 A Lottery, a Lottery, etc.

This Lottery, this Lottery
In Cupid's court went merrily,
 And Cupid played
 A Jewish trade
In this his scheming Lottery;
 For hearts, we're told,
In *shares* he sold
 To many a fond believing drone,
 And cut the hearts
 In sixteen parts
So well, each thought the whole his own,
 A Lottery, a Lottery, etc.

THOMAS MOORE.

CUPID'S CURSE

My love is fair, my love is gay,
As fresh as are the flowers in May;
And of my love the roundelay,
My merry, merry roundelay,
Concludes with Cupid's curse:
They that do change old love for new,
Pray gods they change for worse!

My love can pipe, my love can sing,
My love can many a pretty thing,
And of his lovely praises ring
My merry, merry roundelays.
Amen to Cupid's curse!
They that do change old love for new,
Pray gods they change for worse!

GEORGE PEELE.

LOVE'S FLITTING

*W*HEN Love is coming, coming,
Meet him with songs and joy,
Bid him alight and enter,
Flatter and feast the boy ;
Crown him with gems and roses,
Charm him with winning wiles,
Bind him with lovely garlands,
And kisses, and smiles.

When Love is going, going,
Leaving you all alone,
Craving, the fickle tyrant,
Some newer flave and throne,
Hinder him not, but quickly,
Even though your heart may bleed,
Saddle a horse for his journey,
And bid him God-speed !

ELIZABETH AKERS.

LOVE'S FLITTING

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 Meet him with songs and joy,
Bid him alight and enter,
 Flatter and feast the boy;
Crown him with gems and roses,
 Charm him with winning wiles,
Bind him with lovely garlands,
 And kisses, and smiles.

When Love is going, going,
 Leaving you all alone,
Craving, the fickle tyrant,
 Some newer slave and throne,
Hinder him not, but quickly,
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Saddle a horse for his journey,
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ELIZABETH AKERS.

LOVE'S TYRANNY

LOVE's tyranny now wherefore should I praise,
Not being enamoured of my altered plight !

I often sigh who once sang roundelays ;
I know the sleepless gnomes that haunt the night.

I turn with feverish jealousy to hear
Words that were spoken when I was not near.

I shroud my eyes from sights I dare not see,
Yet who so spies must tell his tale to me.

Madman am I, who give my vote for death,
Yet heed not the grim hand that beckoneth.

Love I entreat to go, and while I pray
Grasp him with nervous fingers, lest he stray.

Ah ! than love's blessing is no deadlier curse,
And yet — and yet — to live undamned were worse.

PERCY HEMINGWAY.

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PERCY HEMINGWAY.

THE TRIUMPH OF CUPID

He came in busy hours—
My holidays are few—
He brought the scent of flowers,
And whispered, dear, of you.

I vowed that I would flay him,
And scourge him out of sight;
Nay more, I vowed to slay him,
The mischief-making sprite.

I gave him caustic chiding,
Let fly a poisoned dart.
Presto! the lad was hiding
Safely within my heart!

There all day long he chatters
Of some one's charm and grace;
Till nothing really matters
Except to see your face.

I would I had not chidden,
Nor tried the sprite to kill;
For in my heart safe hidden,
He works his wayward will.

GERALDINE MEYRICK.

SONG TO CUPID

O wary elf Cupid, O dimpled, coy Cupid,
Are you lost in the moonbeams, or hid in a rose?
Who saw you, so nimble, slip out of a thimble,
And hang from the loops of a lily-maid's bows?

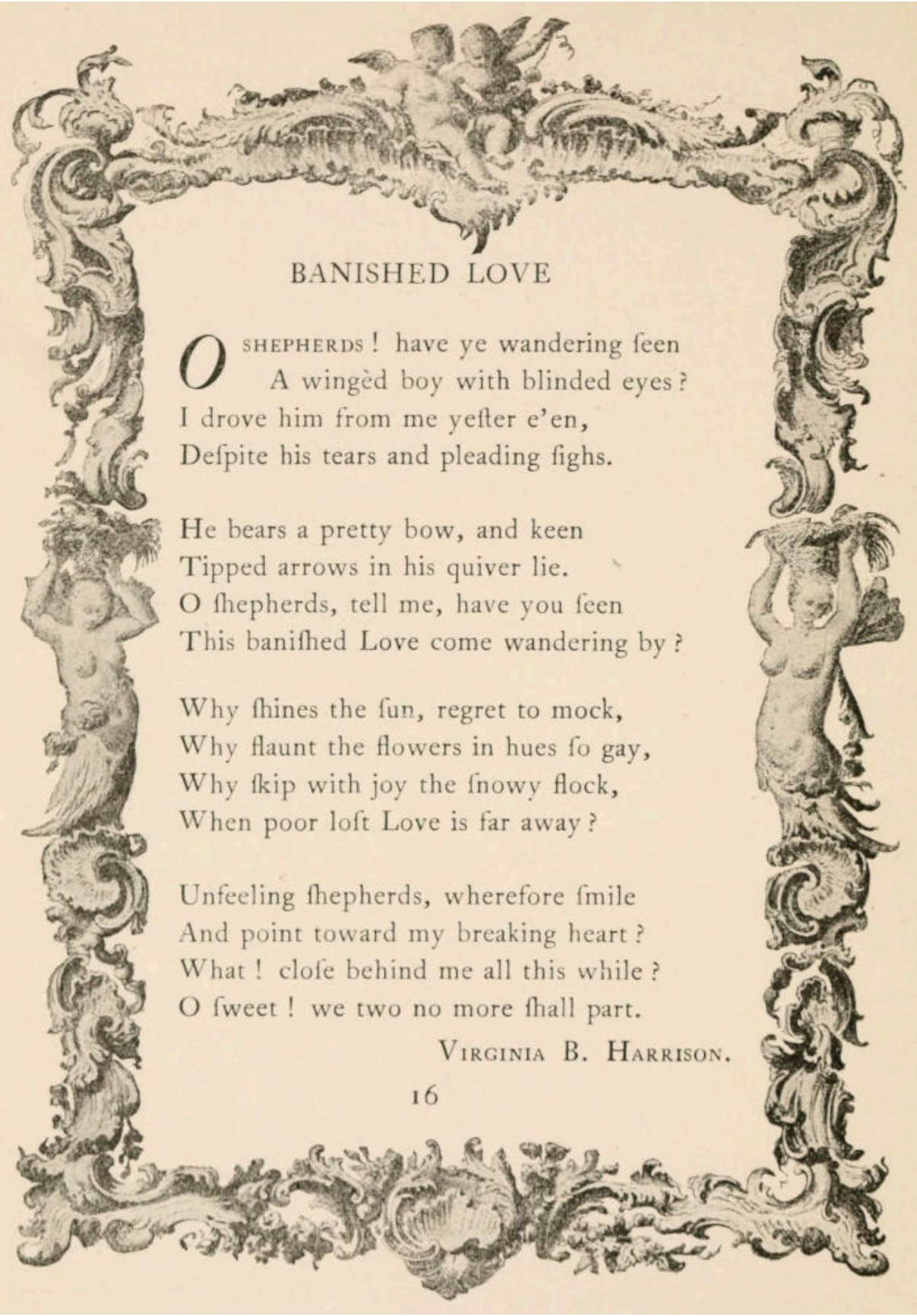
Wee, spry little midget, the world's in a fidget
To snare and then coddle you, mischievous sprite;
Your pranks and mad gambols and primrose-path rambles
'Mid briars and brambles are all my delight.

In ivy-clad bowers you nestle for hours,
And lurk in the flowers that swing in the breeze;
There counting the kisses, the sweet stolen blisses,
Of Strephon and Phyllis in languorous ease.

We trifle and putter, our hearts in a flutter,
In a tangled skein spun by the toiletted fair,
The weary hours whiling, and dull care beguiling—
Lo! dimpled and smiling, you're loitering there!

O wary elf Cupid, O cunning, coy Cupid,
Are lovers all stupid, dear, rollicking boy?
While maidens are sighing and love-knots are tying,
The snap of your bow-string bodes sorrow and joy!

HAROLD VAN SANTVOORD.



BANISHED LOVE

O SHEPHERDS ! have ye wandering seen
A wingèd boy with blinded eyes ?
I drove him from me yester e'en,
Despite his tears and pleading fighs.

He bears a pretty bow, and keen
Tipped arrows in his quiver lie.
O shepherds, tell me, have you seen
This banished Love come wandering by ?

Why shines the sun, regret to mock,
Why flaunt the flowers in hues so gay,
Why skip with joy the snowy flock,
When poor lost Love is far away ?

Unfeeling shepherds, wherefore smile
And point toward my breaking heart ?
What ! close behind me all this while ?
O sweet ! we two no more shall part.

VIRGINIA B. HARRISON.

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VIRGINIA B. HARRISON.

TO CUPID FOR PARDON

CUPID, pardon what is past,
And forgive our sins at last !
Then we will be coy no more,
But thy deity adore ;
Troths at fifteen we will plight,
And will tread a dance each night,
In the fields, or by the fire,
With the youths that have desire.
Given ear-rings we will wear,
Bracelets of our lovers' hair,
Which they on our arms shall twist,
With their names carved, on our wrist :
All the money that we owe
We in tokens will bestow ;
And learn to write that, when 't is sent,
Only our loves know what is meant.
Oh, then pardon what is past,
And forgive our sins at last.

BEAUMONT AND FLETCHER.

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Only our loves know what is meant.
 Oh, then pardon what is past,
 And forgive our sins at last.

BEAUMONT AND FLETCHER.

LOVE'S HUNTING

Hast thou seen a boy so clever,
Bow in hand, and from his shoulders
Three tipped arrows in a quiver,
With which, piercing all beholders,
He goes up and down forever?

One dart, in the deep eye clinging,
Blinds us ever to his aiming;
One straight at the white throat flinging,
He denies his wrong's complaining;
One he leaves in the heart stinging.

And the last dart, tipt with scorning,
Quickly kindles a hot passion
Which consumes us with its burning:
Eyeless, tongueless, in such fashion,
Blind and mute, we wander yearning.

JAMES HERBERT MORSE.

LOVE GOES A-HAWKING

A ho! A ho!

Love's horn doth blow,
And he will out a-hawking go.
His shafts are light as beauty's sighs,
And bright as midnight's brightest eyes,
And round his starry way
The swan-wing'd horses of the skies,
With summer's music in their manes,
Curve their fair necks to zephyr's reins,
And urge their graceful play.

A ho! A ho!

Love's horn doth blow,
And he will out a-hawking go.
The sparrows flutter round his wrist,
The feathery thieves that Venus kist
And taught their morning song,
The linnets seek the airy list,
And swallows too, small pets of Spring,
Bear back the gale with swifter wing,
And dart and wheel along.

A ho! A ho!

Love's horn doth blow,
And he will out a-hawking go.
Now woe to every gnat that skips
To filch the fruit of ladies' lips,
His felon blood is shed;
And woe to flies, whose airy ships
On beauty cast their anchoring bite,
And bandit wasp, that naughty wight,
Whose sting is slaughter-red.

THOMAS LOVELL BEDDOES.

LOVE'S BLINDNESS

I have heard of reasons manifold
Why Love must needs be blind,
But this the best of all I hold—
His eyes are in his mind.

What outward form and feature are
He guesseth but in part;
But that within is good and fair
He seeth with the heart.

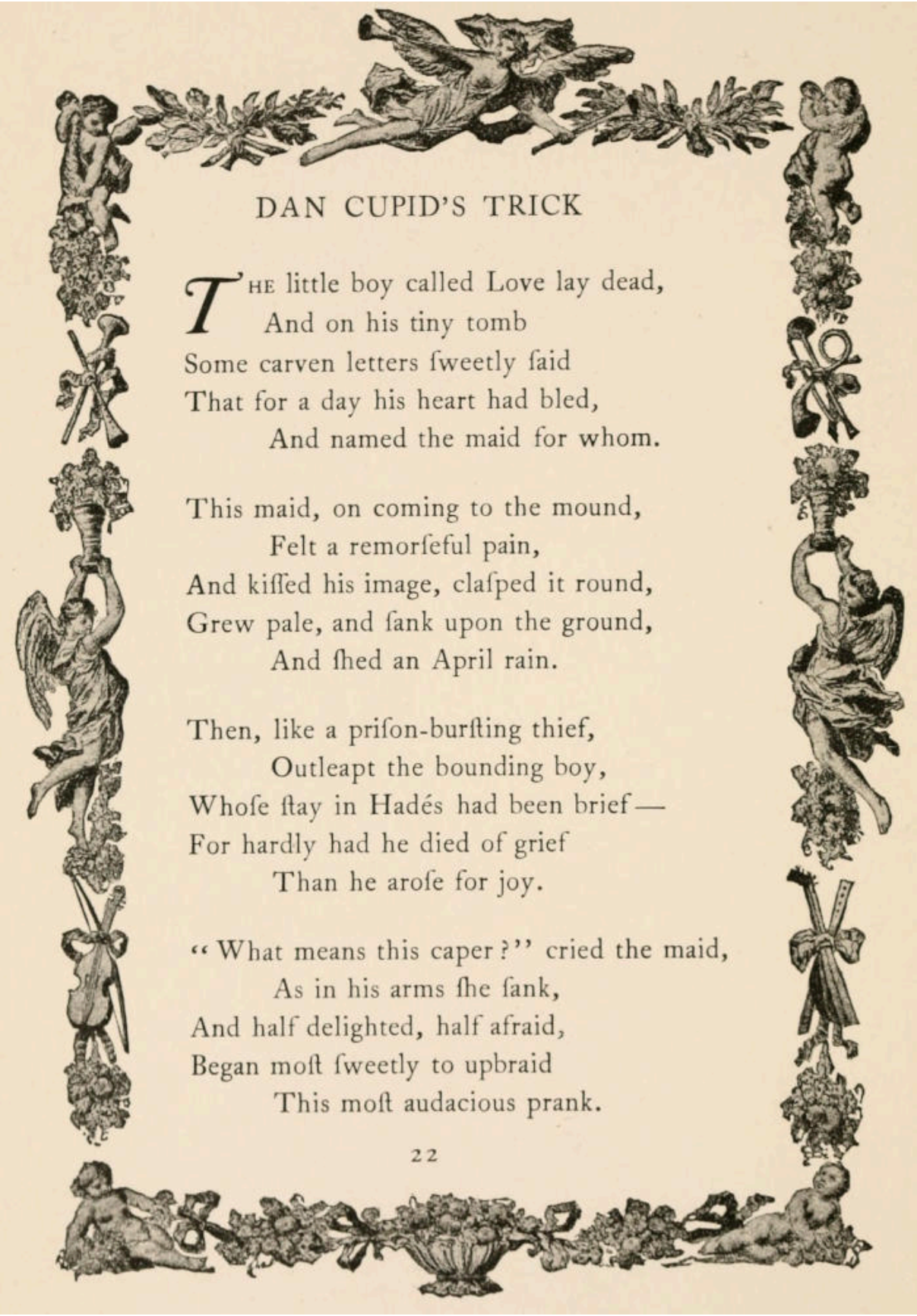
SAMUEL TAYLOR COLERIDGE.

LOVE ASLEEP

I found Love sleeping in a place of shade,
And as in some sweet dream the sweet lips smiled;
Yea, seemed he as a lovely, sleeping child.
Soft kisses on his full, red lips I laid,
And with red roses did his tresses braid;
Then pure, white lilies on his breast I piled,
And fettered him with woodbine sweet and wild,
And fragrant armlets for his arms I made.

But while I, leaning, yearned across his breast,
Upright he sprang, and from swift hand, alert,
Sent forth a shaft that lodged within my heart.
Ah, had I never played with Love at rest,
He had not wakened, had not cast his dart,
And I had lived who die now of this hurt.

PHILIP BOURKE MARSTON.



DAN CUPID'S TRICK

THE little boy called Love lay dead,
And on his tiny tomb
Some carven letters sweetly said
That for a day his heart had bled,
And named the maid for whom.

This maid, on coming to the mound,
Felt a remorseful pain,
And kissed his image, clasped it round,
Grew pale, and sank upon the ground,
And shed an April rain.

Then, like a prison-bursting thief,
Outleapt the bounding boy,
Whose stay in Hadés had been brief—
For hardly had he died of grief
Than he arose for joy.

“What means this caper?” cried the maid,
As in his arms she sank,
And half delighted, half afraid,
Began most sweetly to upbraid
This most audacious prank.

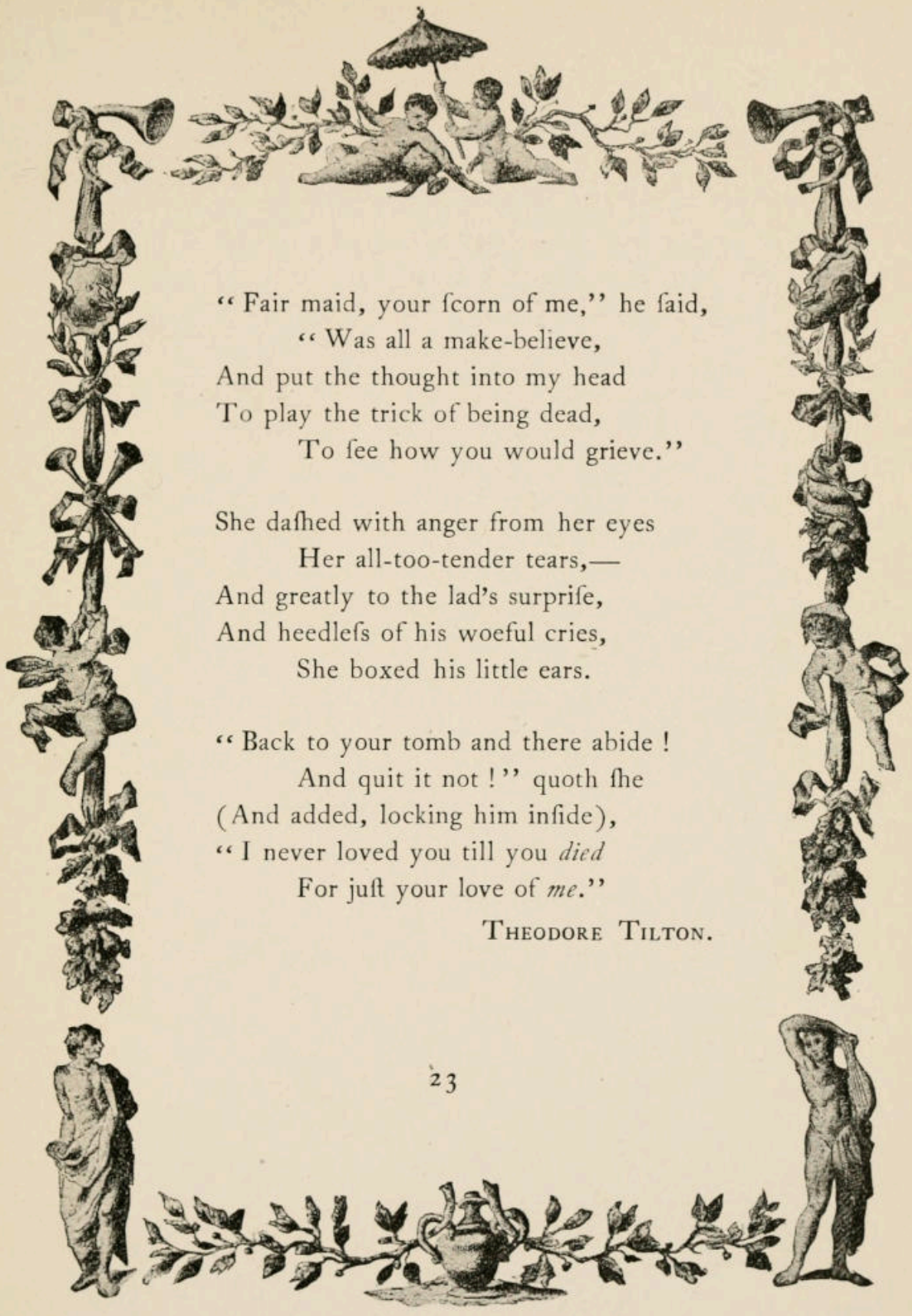
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“Fair maid, your scorn of me,” he said,
“Was all a make-believe,
And put the thought into my head
To play the trick of being dead,
To see how you would grieve.”

She dashed with anger from her eyes
Her all-too-tender tears,—
And greatly to the lad’s surprise,
And heedless of his woeful cries,
She boxed his little ears.

“Back to your tomb and there abide !
And quit it not !” quoth she
(And added, locking him inside),
“I never loved you till you *died*
For just your love of *me*.”

THEODORE TILTON.

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THEODORE TILTON.

LOVE'S ARROWS

I saw young Love make trial of his bow,
 In May's green garden where he shot his dart,
 Nor recked if any nigh beheld his art,
But other eyes did mark him as I know;
For my sweet lady sate anear his throw,
 And I with her, and joinèd heart to heart,
 So that we might not feel the bitter smart
Love leaveth there when time doth force to go.

We heard Love's arrows falling in the grass,
 Or watched them quiver in the targe below;
Yet few to us came nigh, nor might they pass
Beyond our feet, which trembled when they came,
Whose hearts were not the quarry for his aim,
 That in Love's chase fell stricken long ago.

WALTER CRANE.

LOVE, THE GUEST

I did not dream that Love would stay,
I deemed him but a passing guest,
Yet here he lingers many a day.

I said, "Young Love will flee with May,
And leave forlorn the hearth he blest";
I did not dream that Love would stay.

My envious neighbor mocks me "Nay,
Love lies not long in any nest";
Yet here he lingers many a day.

And though I did his will alway,
And gave him even of my best;
I did not dream that Love would stay.

I have no skill to bid him stay,
Of tripping tongue or cunning jest,
Yet here he lingers many a day.

Beneath his ivory feet I lay
Pale plumage of the ringdove's breast;
I did not dream that Love would stay.

Will Love be flown? I oftentimes say,
Home turning for the noonday rest;
Yet here he lingers many a day.

His gold curls gleam, his lips are gay,
His eyes through tears smile loveliest;
I did not dream that love would stay.

He sometimes sighs when far away

The low red sun makes fair the west,
Yet here he lingers many a day.

Thrice blest of all men am I! yea,
Although of all unworthiest;
I did not dream that Love would stay,
Yet here he lingers many a day.

GRAHAM R. TOMSON.

CUPID

Selfish rogue, did Psyche dream,
When her lamp she held above him,
How the oil would downward stream,
Wake the rogue and make her love him?

MARY CHACE PECKHAM.

FOR CUPID DEAD

When Love is dead, what more but funeral rites—
To lay his sweet corpse lovingly to rest,
To cover him with rose and eglantine,
And all fair posies that he loved the best?

What more, but kisses for his close-shut eyes—
His cold, still lips that never more will speak—
His hair, too bright for dust of death to dim—
The flush scarce faded from his frozen cheek?

What more but tears that will not warm his brow,
Although they burn the eyes from which they start?—
No bitter weeping or more bitter words
Can rouse to one more throb that pulseless heart.

So dead he is, who once was so alive!
In summer, when the ardent days were long,
He was as warm as June, as gay and glad
As any bird that swelled its throat with song.

So dead!—yet all things were his ministers—
All birds and blossoms, and the joyous June!
Would they had died, and kept sweet Love alive;
Since he is gone the world is out of tune.

LOUISE CHANDLER MOULTON.

AT THE SIGN OF THE BLIND CUPID

*W*HEN blushing cheeks and downcast eyes
Set all the heart aflame,
When love within a dimple lies
And constancy 's a name,
Since every lass is passing fair,
Cupid must fly and see ;
And, lightly flitting here and there,
A wingèd boy is he.

When creeping years steal on apace
And youth and vigor go,
When time with wrinkles marks the face
And strews the hair with snow,
Ah, then no wingèd boy is he ;
But strong-limbed and complete,
With blinded eyes that need not see,
Since memory guides his feet.

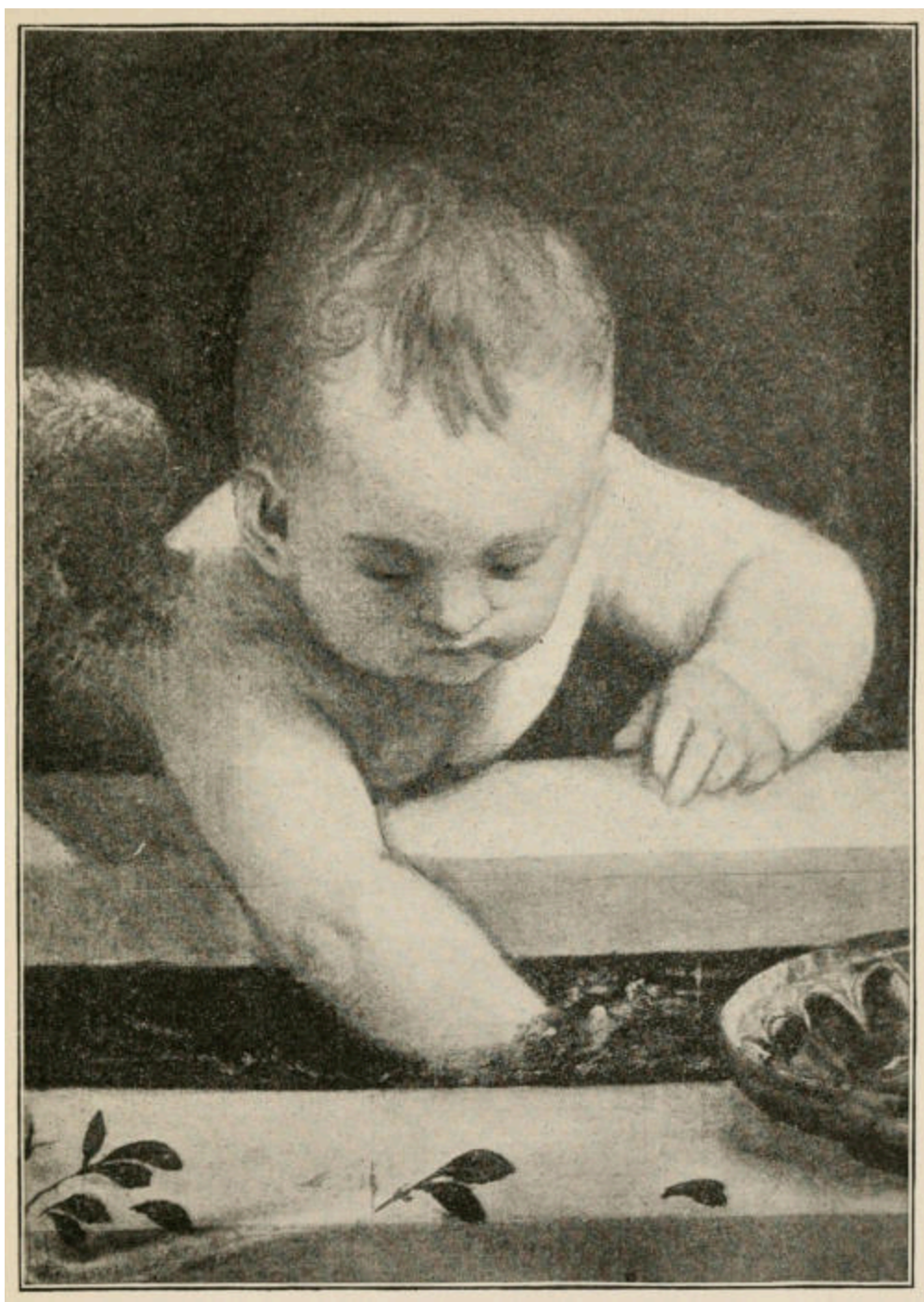
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WALTER LEARNED.



CUPID'S ARROW

Young Cupid went storming to Vulcan one day,
And besought him to look at his arrow.
“’Tis useless!” he cried, “you must mend it, I say,
’Tisn’t fit to let fly at a sparrow.
There’s something that’s wrong in the shaft, or the dart,
For it flutters quite false to my aim,
’Tis an age since it fairly went home to a heart,
And the world really jests at my name.

“I have straightened, I’ve bent, I’ve tried all, I declare,
I’ve perfumed it with sweetest of sighs;
’Tis feathered with ringlets my mother might wear,
And the barb gleams with light from young eyes;
But it falls without touching—I’ll break it, I vow,
For there’s Hymen beginning to pout,
He’s complaining his torch beam’s so dull and so low,
That Zephyr might puff it right out.”

Little Cupid went on with his pitiful tale,
Till Vulcan the weapon restored.
“There, take it, young sir, try it now. If it fail,
I will ask neither fee nor reward!”
The urchin shot out, and rare havoc he made,
The wounded and dead were untold,
But no wonder the rogue had such slaughtering trade,
For the arrow was laden with gold.

ELIZA COOK.

CUPID PLAGUE THEE FOR THY TREASON

Now I see thy looks were feigned,
Quickly lost, and quickly gained;
Soft thy skin, like wool of wethers,
Heart inconstant, light as feathers,
Tongue untrusty, subtle-sighted,
Wanton will with change delighted.
 Siren, pleasant foe to reason,
 Cupid plague thee for thy treason!

Of thine eye I made my mirror,
From thy beauty came my error,
All thy words I counted witty,
All thy sighs I deemed pity,
Thy false tears that me aggrieved,
First of all my trust deceived.
 Siren, pleasant foe to reason,
 Cupid plague thee for thy treason!

Feigned acceptance when I asked,
Lovely words with cunning masked,
Holy vows, but heart unholy;
Wretched man, my trust was folly;
Lily white, and pretty winking,
Solemn vows but sorry thinking.
 Siren, pleasant foe to reason,
 Cupid plague thee for thy treason!

Now I see, O seemly cruel,
Others warm them at my fuel,
Wit shall guide me in this durance
Since in love is no assurance:
Change thy pasture, take thy pleasure,
Beauty is a fading treasure.

Siren, pleasant foe to reason,
Cupid plague thee for thy treason!

Prime youth lasts not, age will follow
And make white those tresses yellow,
Wrinkled face, for looks delightful,
Shall acquaint the dame despiteful.
And when time shall date thy glory,
Then too late thou wilt be sorry.

Siren, pleasant foe to reason,
Cupid plague thee for thy treason!

THOMAS LODGE.

YOUNG LOVE'S A GALLANT BOY

When Love came first to earth, the Spring
Spread rose-beds to receive him,
And back he vowed his flight he'd wing
To Heaven, if she should leave him.

But Spring departing, saw his faith
Pledged to the next new-comer—
He revelled in the warmer breath
And richer bowers of Summer.

Then sportive Autumn claimed by rights
An Archer for her lover,
And even in Winter's dark cold nights
A charm he could discover.

Her routs and balls, and fireside joy,
For this time were his reasons—
In short, Young Love's a gallant boy,
That likes all times and seasons.

THOMAS CAMPBELL.

VENUS' RUNAWAY

*B*EAUTIES, have ye seen this toy,
Called Love, a little boy,
Almost naked, wanton, blind ;
Cruel now, and then as kind ?
If he be amongst ye, say ?
He is Venus' runaway.

He hath marks about him plenty :
You shall know him among twenty.
All his body is a fire,
And his breath a flame entire,
That, being shot like lightning in,
Wounds the heart, but not the skin.

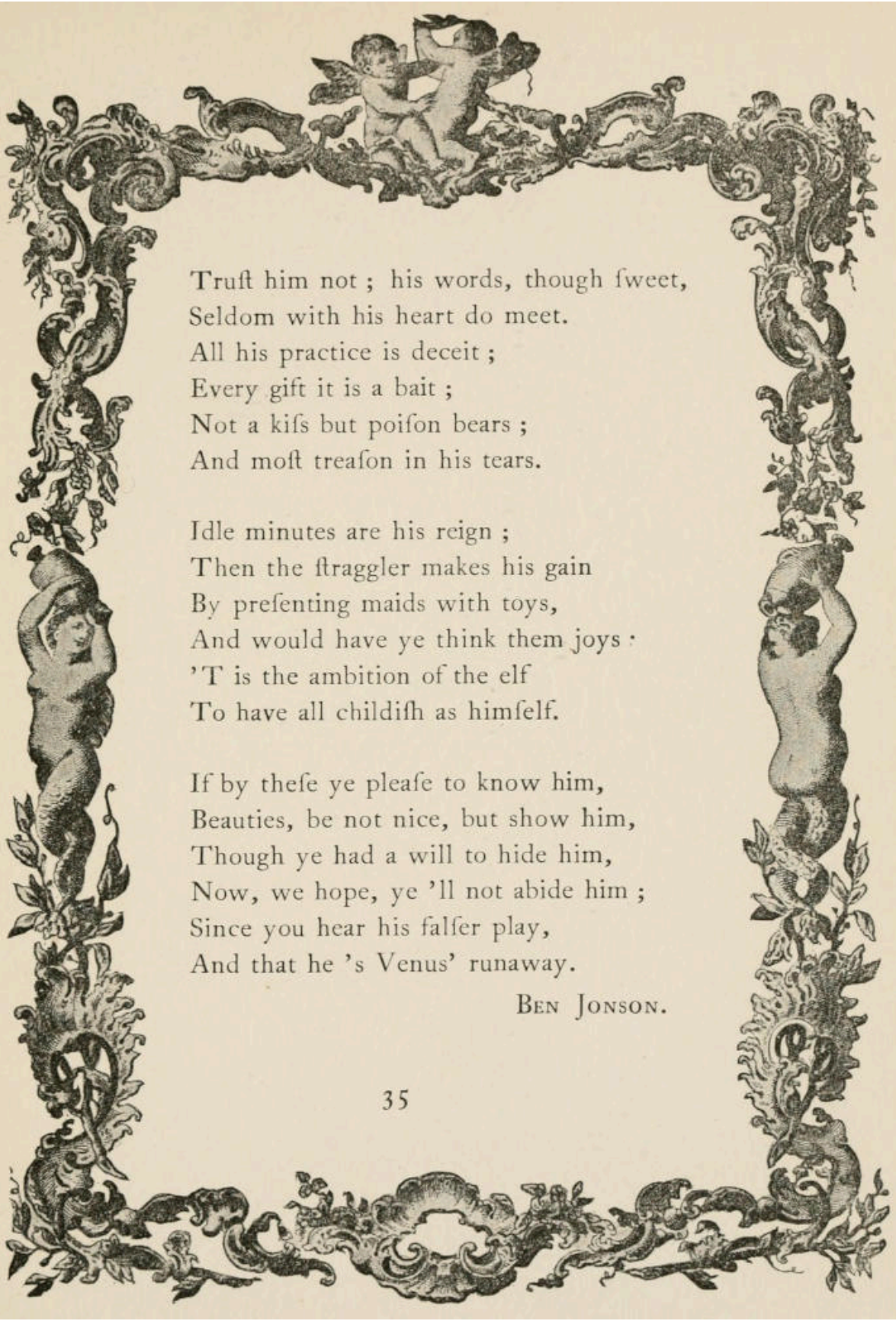
At his sight the sun hath turned,
Neptune in the waters burned ;
Hell hath felt a greater heat ;
Jove himself forsook his seat.
From the center to the sky
Are his trophies reared high.

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Trust him not ; his words, though sweet,
Seldom with his heart do meet.
All his practice is deceit ;
Every gift it is a bait ;
Not a kifs but poison bears ;
And most treason in his tears.

Idle minutes are his reign ;
Then the straggler makes his gain
By presenting maids with toys,
And would have ye think them joys :
'T is the ambition of the elf
To have all childish as himself.

If by these ye please to know him,
Beauties, be not nice, but show him,
Though ye had a will to hide him,
Now, we hope, ye 'll not abide him ;
Since you hear his falser play,
And that he 's Venus' runaway.

BEN JONSON.

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BEN JONSON.

BEWARE THE ROGUE

Deep in the shadow of her hazel eyes,
Waiting to capture men, Love lurking lies.
Her glances are the arrows of his bow,
Wherewith he lays unwary victims low;
And she, unused to Cupid's artful wiles,
Unconscious aids his purpose by her smiles,
And knows not, as her smiles and glances dart,
What anguish these may bring to many a heart.

Ah! hapless maiden, innocently gay,
No presage of the future breeds dismay;
She does not know how soon the treacherous guest
Will make her heart the haven of unrest.
Ungrateful Cupid! Soon from her he'll fly,
And seek a refuge in some lover's eye,
Then from that point of vantage aim a dart
To pierce and agonize her maiden heart.

THOMAS DUNN ENGLISH.

THE FAIR THIEF

Before the urchin well could go
She stole the whiteness of the snow,
And more that whiteness to adorn
She stole the blushes of the morn;
Stole all the sweets that either sheds
On primrose buds or violet beds.

Still, to reveal her artful wiles,
She stole the Graces' silken smiles:
She stole Aurora's balmy breath,
And pilfered orient pearl for teeth:
The cherry, dipt in morning dew,
Gave moisture to her lips and hue.

These were her infant spoils, a store
To which in time she added more:
At twelve she stole from Cyprus' queen
Her air and love-commanding mien;
Stole Juno's dignity, and stole
From Pallas sense to charm the soul.

Apollo's wit was next her prey;
Her next, the beam that lights the day.
She sung: amazed the Sirens heard,
And to assert their voice appeared:
She played: the Muses from the hill
Wondered who thus had stol'n their skill.

Great Jove approved her crimes and art;
And t'other day she stole my heart!
If lovers, Cupid, are thy care,
Exert thy vengeance on this Fair;
To trial bring her stolen charms,

And let her prison be my arms.

CHARLES WYNDHAM.

LOVE AND THE WITCHES

It was a little, fearful maid,
Whose mother left her all alone;
Her door with iron bolt she stayed,
And 'gainst it rolled a lucky stone—
For many a night she'd waked with fright when witches by the house had
flown.

To piping lute in still midnight,
Who comes a-singing at the door,—
That showeth seams of golden light,—
“Ah, open, darling, I implore”?
She could not help knowing 'twas Love, although they'd never met before.

She swiftly shot the iron bar,
And rolled the lucky stone away,
And careful set the door ajar—
“Now enter in, Sir Love, I pray;
My mother knows it not, but I have watched for you this many a day.”

With fan and roar of gloomy wings
They gave the door a windy shove;
They perched on chairs and brooms and things;
Like bats they beat around above—
Poor little maid, she'd let the witches in with Love.

MARY E. WILKINS.

LOVE AND DREAM

Cupid, wandering one May-day,
Met with loitering Death by chance;
No aged carl as many say,
But young as he, as fair and gay,
As fond of boyish sport or dance.

“Come, wrestle,” and, so saying, Love,
Loos’ning the quiver at his breast,
Hung it upon the bough above.
“These arrows,” quoth he, “when they rove,
Make youth a slave at my behest.”

Among the tender-blooming leaves
Death made *his* quiver sure and fast,
“*My* arrows bring rest when age grieves,”
And down unwary Love he heaves;
So frolicked they till Discord passed.

She, wicked, hating merry play,
Scattered their arrows on the green,
And thus confused, some got astray
In either quiver. Since that day
Youth dies and old age dotes, I ween.

ANNA VERNON DORSEY.

CUPID LAID BY HIS BRAND

Cupid laid by his brand, and fell asleep:
A maid of Dian's this advantage found,
And his love-kindling fire did quickly steep
In a cold valley-fountain of that ground;
Which borrowed from this holy fire of Love
A dateless lively heat, still to endure,
And grew a seething bath, which yet men prove
Against strange maladies a sovereign cure.
But at my mistress' eye Love's brand new-fired,
The boy for trial needs would touch my breast;
I, sick withal, the help of bath desired,
And thither hied, a sad distempered guest,
 But found no cure; the bath for my help lies
 Where Cupid got new fire—my mistress' eyes.

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE.

A MADRIGAL

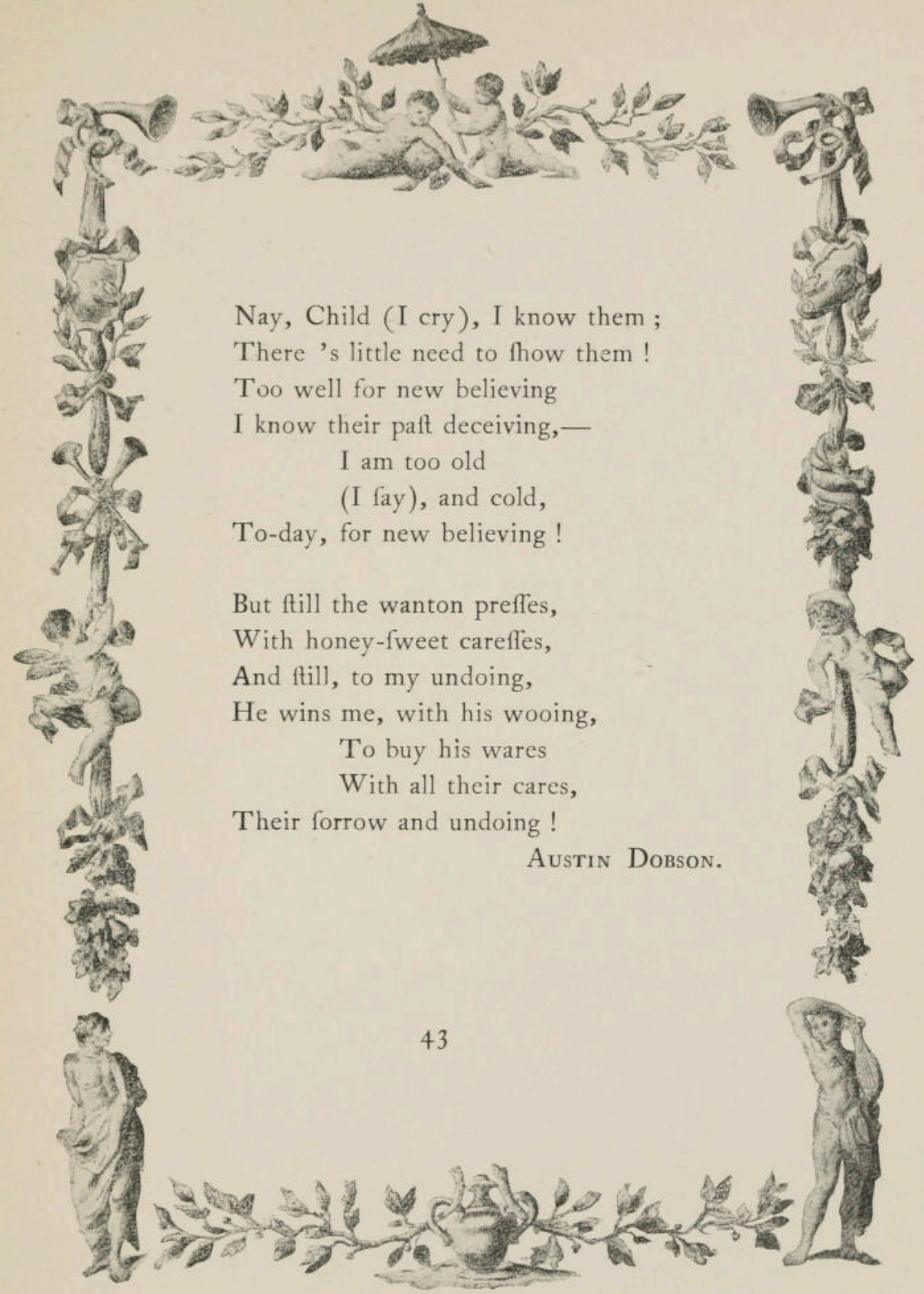
*B*EFORE me careless lying,
Young Love his ware comes crying ;
Full soon the elf untreaasures
His pack of pains and pleasures,—
 With roguish eye
 He bids me buy
From out his pack of treasures.

His wallet 's stuffed with blisses,
With true-love-knots and kisses,
With rings and rosy fetters,
And sugared vows and letters ;—
 He holds them out
 With boyish flout,
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A decorative border surrounds the text. At the top, two cherubs sit under a parasol. The left and right sides are adorned with vertical garlands of flowers and leaves, each topped with a trumpet. At the bottom, two female figures stand on either side of a central floral arrangement featuring a large vase.

Nay, Child (I cry), I know them ;
There 's little need to show them !
Too well for new believing
I know their past deceiving,—
 I am too old
 (I say), and cold,
To-day, for new believing !

But still the wanton pressies,
With honey-sweet careffes,
And still, to my undoing,
He wins me, with his wooing,
 To buy his wares
 With all their cares,
Their sorrow and undoing !

AUSTIN DOBSON.

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LOVE'S REWARD

For Love I labored all the day,
Through morning chill and midday heat.
For surely with the evening gray,
I thought, Love's guerdon shall be sweet.

At eventide, with weary limb,
I brought my labors to the spot
Where Love had bid me come to him;
Thither I came, but found him not.

For he with idle folk had gone
To dance the hours of night away;
And I that toiled was left alone,
Too weary now to dance or play.

FRANCIS W. BOURDILLON.

THE LOVE THAT IS REQUITED WITH DISDAIN

In search of things that secret are my mated muse began,
What it might be molested most the head and mind of man;
The bending brow of prince's face, to wrath that doth attend,
Or want of parents, wife, or child, or loss of faithful friend;
The roaring of the cannon shot, that makes the piece to shake,
Or terror, such as mighty Jove from heaven above can make:
All these in fine, may not compare, experience so doth prove,
Unto the torments, sharp and strange, of such as be in love.
Love looks aloft, and laughs to scorn all such as griefs annoy,
The more extreme their passions be, the greater is his joy,
Thus Love, as victor of the field, triumphs above the rest,
And joys to see his subjects lie with living death in breast;
But dire Disdain lets drive a shaft, and galls this bragging fool,
He plucks his plumes, unbends his bow, and sets him new to school;
Whereby this boy that bragged late, as conqueror over all,
Now yields himself unto Disdain, his vassal and his thrall.

WILLIAM HUNNIS.

CUPID RELIEVED

As once young Cupid went astray,
The little god I found;
I took his bow and shafts away,
And fast his pinions bound.

At Chloe's feet my spoils I cast,
My conquest proud to shew;
She saw his godship fettered fast
And smiled to see him so.

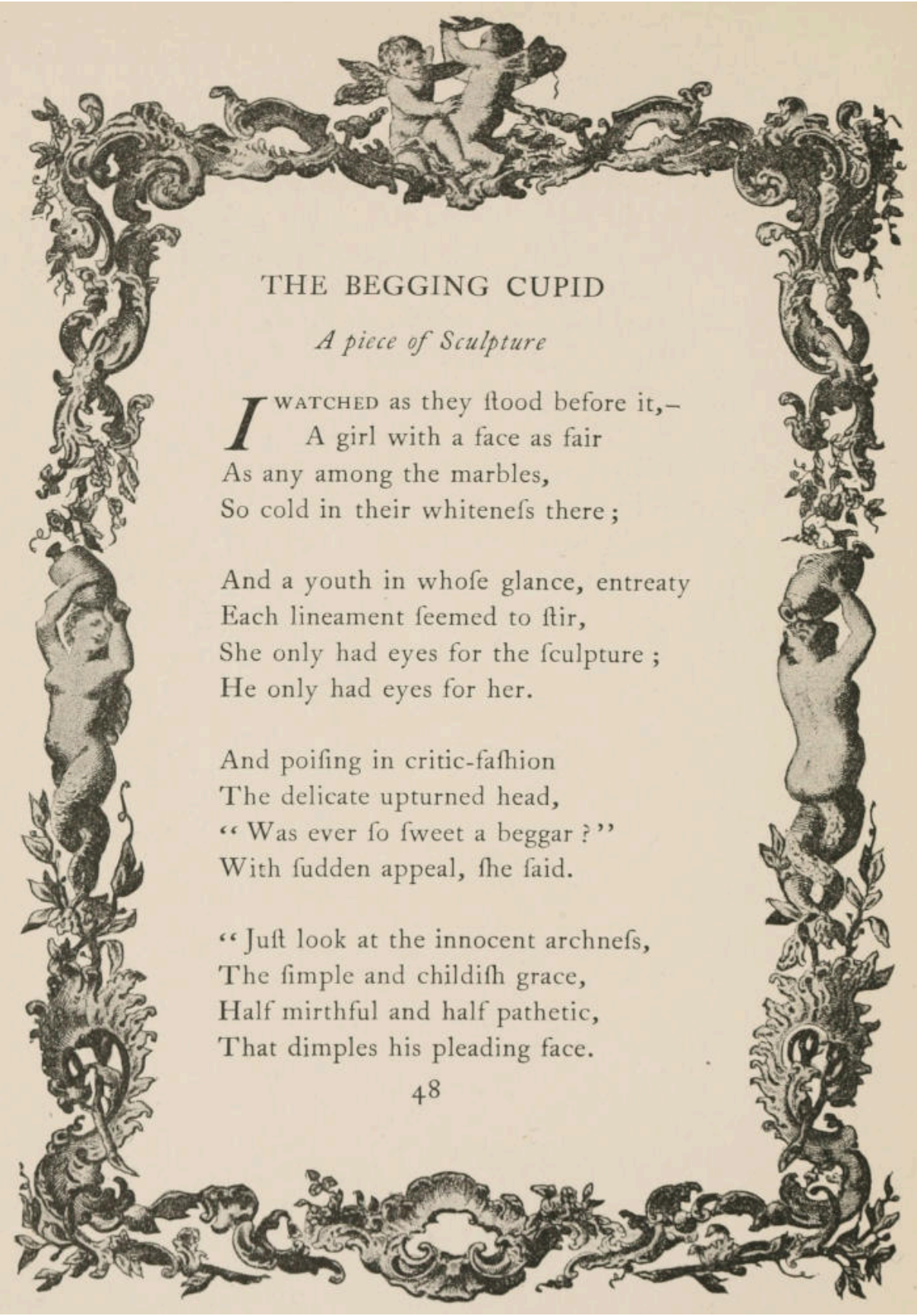
But ah! that smile such fresh supplies
Of arms resistless gave!
I'm forced again to yield my prize,
And fall again his slave.

SOAME JENYNS.

LOVE BANISHED HEAVEN

Love banished heaven, in earth was held in scorn,
Wand'ring abroad in need and beggary;
And wanting friends, though of a goddess born,
Yet craved the alms of such as passèd by:
I, like a man devout and charitable,
Clothed the naked, lodged this wand'ring guest,
With sighs and tears still furnishing his table,
With what might make the miserable blest;
But this ungrateful, for my good desert,
Enticed my thoughts against me to conspire,
Who gave consent to steal away my heart,
And set my breast his lodging on a fire.
Well, well, my friends, when beggars grow thus bold,
No marvel then though charity grow cold.

MICHAEL DRAYTON.



THE BEGGING CUPID

A piece of Sculpture

I WATCHED as they stood before it,—
A girl with a face as fair
As any among the marbles,
So cold in their whiteness there ;

And a youth in whose glance, entreaty
Each lineament seemed to stir,
She only had eyes for the sculpture ;
He only had eyes for her.

And posing in critic-fashion
The delicate upturned head,
“ Was ever so sweet a beggar ? ”
With sudden appeal, she said.

“ Just look at the innocent archness,
The simple and childish grace,
Half mirthful and half pathetic,
That dimples his pleading face.

THE BEGGING CUPID

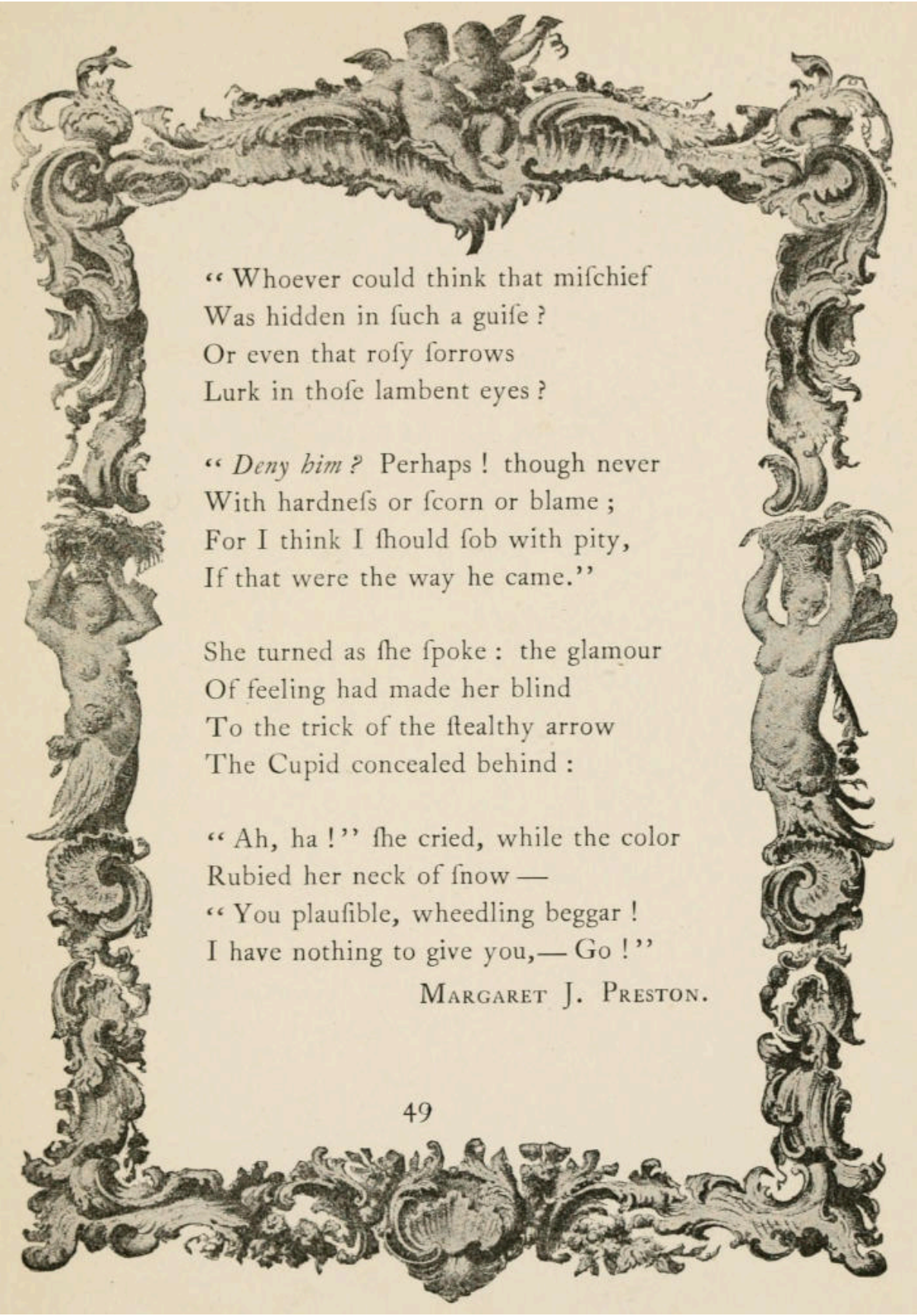
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She only had eyes for the sculpture;
He only had eyes for her.

And poising in critic-fashion
The delicate upturned head,
“Was ever so sweet a beggar?”
With sudden appeal, she said.

“Just look at the innocent archness,
The simple and childish grace,
Half mirthful and half pathetic,
That dimples his pleading face.



“Whoever could think that mischief
Was hidden in such a guise?
Or even that rosy sorrows
Lurk in those lambent eyes?”

“*Deny him?* Perhaps! though never
With hardness or scorn or blame;
For I think I should sob with pity,
If that were the way he came.”

She turned as she spoke: the glamour
Of feeling had made her blind
To the trick of the stealthy arrow
The Cupid concealed behind:

“Ah, ha!” she cried, while the color
Rubied her neck of snow—
“You plausible, wheedling beggar!
I have nothing to give you,—Go!”

MARGARET J. PRESTON.

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LOVE! IF A GOD THOU ART

Love! if a god thou art,
Then evermore thou must
Be merciful and just;
If thou be just, O wherefore doth thy dart
Wound mine alone, and not my lady's heart?
If merciful, then why
Am I to pain reserved,
Who have thee truly served,
While she, that by thy power fits not afly,
Laughs thee to scorn, and lives at liberty?
Then, if a god thou wilt accounted be,
Heal me like her, or else wound her like me.

FRANCIS DAVISON.

LOVE'S GOING

Love lies a-sleeping; maiden, softly sing,
Lest he should waken; pluck the falling rose
A-brushing 'gainst his cheek, her glowing heart
Ope'd to the sun's hot kisses—foolish thing,
To list the tale oft told!—but summer goes,
And all the roses' petals fall apart.

Love lies a-sleeping; let the curtains part
So that the breeze may lightly to him sing
A lullaby—the changeful breeze that goes
A-whispering through the grass, where'er it rose,
Where'er it listeth bound, a wilful thing,
Low murmuring sweets from an inconstant heart.

Love lies a-sleeping: press the pulsing heart
That beats against thy bosom: stand apart
And stay thine eager breath, lest anything
Should mar his rest—the songs that lovers sing,
The tale the butterfly tells to the rose,
The low wind to the grass, and onward goes.

Love lies a-sleeping: ah, how swiftly goes
The sweet delusion he hath taught thy heart,
Fair maiden, pressing to thy breast the rose,
Whose fun-kissed petals sadly fall apart,
With thy quick breath! Thy rhyme wouldst hear him sing
Which yesterday seemed such a foolish thing?

Love lies a-sleeping: nay, for such a thing
Break not his slumber. See how sweetly goes
That smile across his lips, that will not sing
For very wilfulness. Love hath no heart!
If he should wake, these red-ripe lips would part

In laughter low to see this ravished rose.

Love lies a-sleeping: so the full-blown rose
Falls to the earth a dead unpitied thing;
The grasses 'neath the breeze deep-sighing part
And sway; and as thy warm breath comes and goes
In motion with the red tides of thy heart,
The song is hushed which Love was wont to sing.

Love lies a-sleeping: thus in dreams he goes;
Strive not to waken him, but tell thy heart.
“Love lies a-sleeping, and he may not sing.”

CHARLES W. COLEMAN, JUN.

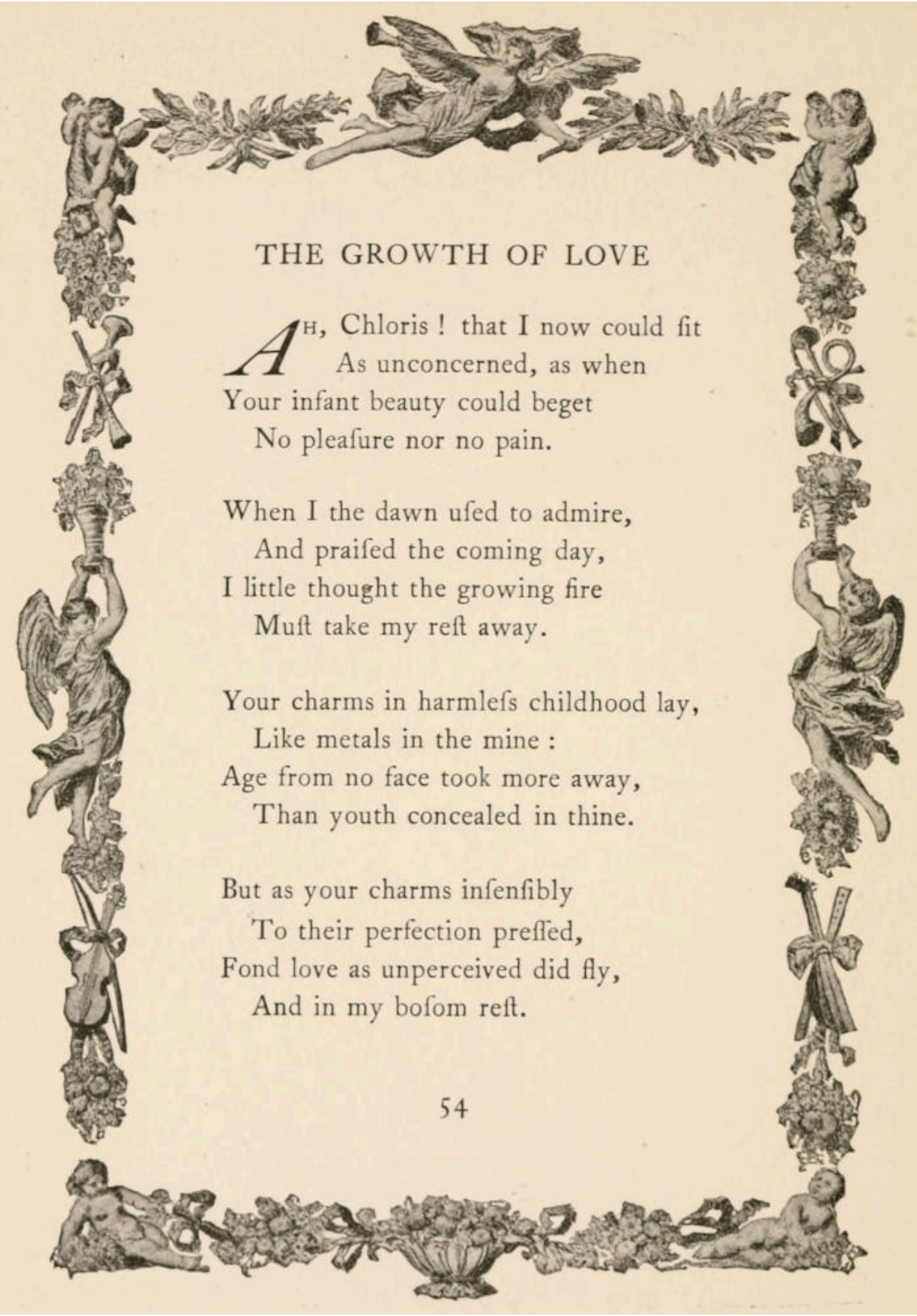
CUPID'S ARROWS

Phœbe, wandering in a wood,
 Chanced to spy Dan Cupid sleeping;
Long the curious maiden stood
 Tiptoe, through the branches peeping.
For the youngster's lips she yearned,
 Till, the branches parting slyly,
She to slake her thirst that burned
 Stooped and kissed the rogue's mouth shyly.

Now the boy's eyes open wide,
 And upon the maid he gazes,
Grasps an arrow at his side,
 And his silver bow upraises.
Swift the maiden turns to flee;
 Swift the arrow follows after,
Wounding in its flight a tree:
 Hark! how rings the maid's clear laughter.

Cupid, with sleep-dazzled eyes,
 Stares a moment through the bushes
Where the laughing maid still flies,
 Then adown the wood he rushes.
Now the shaft o'ertakes the quarry,
 Now it cleaves poor Phœbe's heart—
Maidens, ere you wake Love, tarry
 First to filch his every dart.

JAMES B. KENYON.



THE GROWTH OF LOVE

A^H, Chloris ! that I now could fit
As unconcerned, as when
Your infant beauty could beget
No pleasure nor no pain.

When I the dawn used to admire,
And praised the coming day,
I little thought the growing fire
Must take my rest away.

Your charms in harmless childhood lay,
Like metals in the mine :
Age from no face took more away,
Than youth concealed in thine.

But as your charms insensibly
To their perfection pressed,
Fond love as unperceived did fly,
And in my bosom rest.

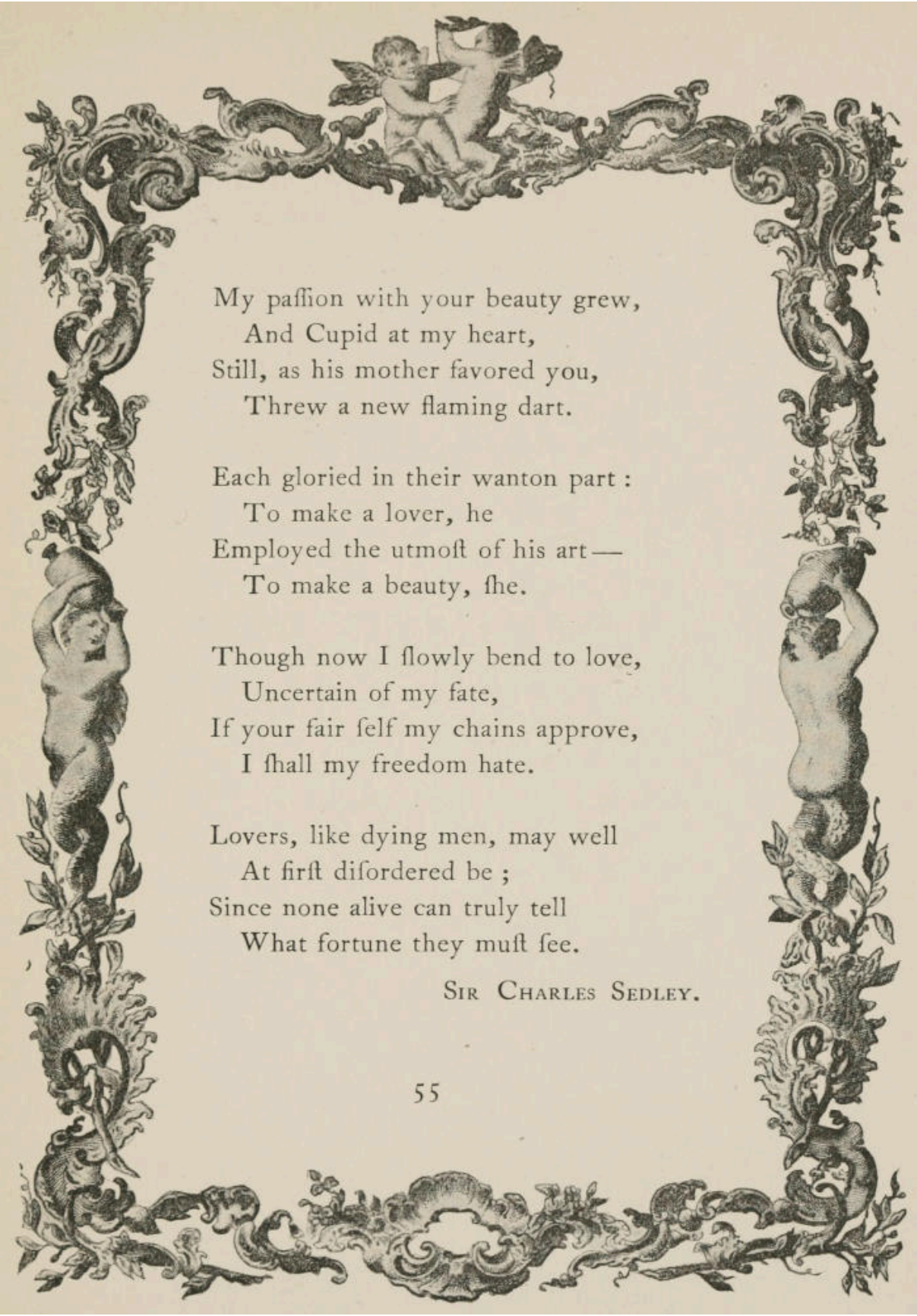
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My passion with your beauty grew,
And Cupid at my heart,
Still, as his mother favored you,
Threw a new flaming dart.

Each gloried in their wanton part :
To make a lover, he
Employed the utmost of his art —
To make a beauty, she.

Though now I slowly bend to love,
Uncertain of my fate,
If your fair self my chains approve,
I shall my freedom hate.

Lovers, like dying men, may well
At first disordered be ;
Since none alive can truly tell
What fortune they must see.

SIR CHARLES SEDLEY.

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LOVE'S QUALITIES

Is Love a boy—what means he then to strike?
Or is he blind,—why will he be a guide?
Is he a man,—why doth he hurt his like?
Is he a god,—why doth he men deride?
No one of these, but one compact of all:
A wilful boy, a man still dealing blows,
Of purpose blind to lead men to their thrall:
A god that rules unruly—God, he knows.

Boy! pity me that am a child again;
Blind, be no more my guide to make me stray:
Man! use thy might to force away my pain;
God! do me good and lead me to my way;
And if thou beest a power to me unknown,
Power of my life! let here thy grace be shown.

BYRD'S SET SONGS.

BALLADE OF THE ROSE

Tell me, red rose, what you were bid—

You know her secret; you she wore
Shy, nestling in her hair, half hid
By jealous golden curls a score,
As waves half timid kiss the shore,
Then tremble were they bold or no;
I kiss you, blushing token, for
She loves me—rose, you tell me so.

I softly raise your scented lid,
Where, sleeping since some dawn of yore,
A crystal dewdrop lies amid
The downy crimson of your core.
I am not versed in Cupid's lore;
But so I think her blushing glow
Soft guards the love I sue her for.
She loves me—rose, you tell me so.

And when her hand, in dainty kid,
Gave you to me, as n'er before
It fluttered, tried itself to rid
Of fetters that it never wore,
Why trembled she? My eyes would pour
My love in hers—why did she so?
Was it because she hates me, or—
She loves me—rose, you tell me so.

L'ENVOY

Rose, come you not ambassador
From Cupid's court to let me know
Love yields at last? Speak, I implore!
She loves me—rose, you tell me so.

H. C. FAULKNER.

AN AWAKENING

Love had forgotten and gone to sleep;
Love had forgotten the present and past.
I was so glad when he ceased to weep;
“Now he is quiet,” I whispered, “at last.”

What sent you here on that night of all nights,
Breaking his slumber, dreamless and deep,
Just as I whispered below my breath,
“Love has forgotten and gone to sleep”?

ANNE REEVE ALDRICH.

LOVE AND A COMPASS

To the north of her mouth, east and west of her eyes,
By the curls of her tresses half hidden,
Two ears, of the tiniest, daintiest size,
Are kissed by the breezes unbidden.

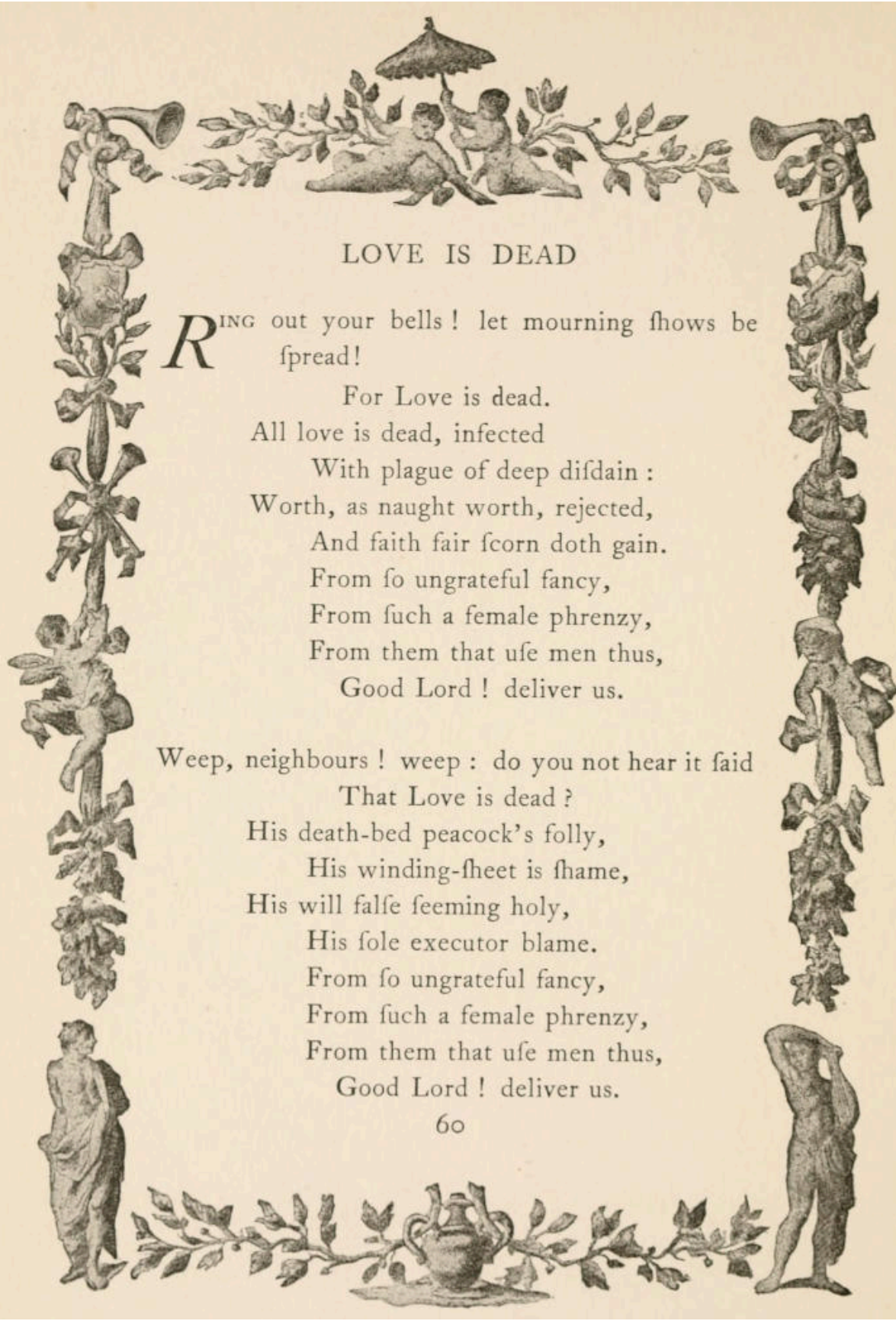
And right to the north of each exquisite cheek
Lie her eyes, of a brilliancy tender.
Their color I know not, but in them I seek
Some sign of approaching surrender.

Due north of the dimple that hides in her chin,
Two lips conceal music behind them;
And when a smile plays on them, Cupids begin
To break from the bonds that confine them.

Just south of her chin stands a full-rounded throat,
Whose whiteness than marble is whiter;
Southeast and southwest of it, shoulders I note—
No curves are more graceful, or lighter.

In the south of her bosom, a bit to the west,
Is the greatest of all of her beauties:
My loadstar's the heart that is hid in her breast;
To obey it's my sweetest of duties.

S. D. SMITH, JR.



LOVE IS DEAD

RING out your bells ! let mourning shows be spread !

For Love is dead.
All love is dead, infected
With plague of deep disdain :
Worth, as naught worth, rejected,
And faith fair scorn doth gain.
From so ungrateful fancy,
From such a female phrenzy,
From them that use men thus,
Good Lord ! deliver us.

Weep, neighbours ! weep : do you not hear it said
That Love is dead ?
His death-bed peacock's folly,
His winding-sheet is shame,
His will false seeming holy,
His sole executor blame.
From so ungrateful fancy,
From such a female phrenzy,
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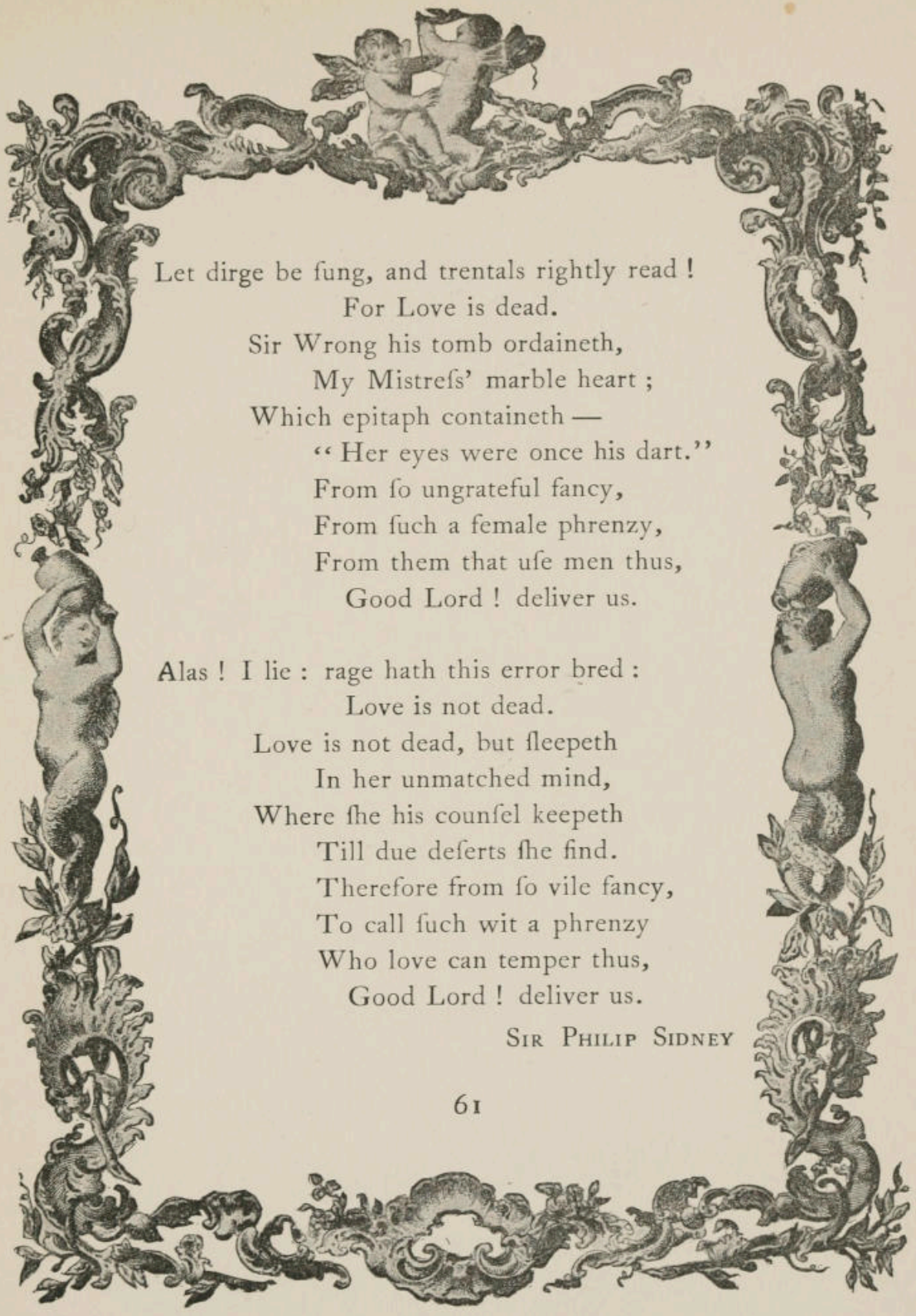
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Let dirge be fung, and trentals rightly read !

For Love is dead.

Sir Wrong his tomb ordaineth,

My Mistrefs' marble heart ;

Which epitaph containeth —

“ Her eyes were once his dart.”

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Alas ! I lie : rage hath this error bred :

Love is not dead.

Love is not dead, but sleepeth

In her unmatched mind,

Where she his counsel keepeth

Till due deserts she find.

Therefore from so vile fancy,

To call such wit a phrenzy

Who love can temper thus,

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SIR PHILIP SIDNEY

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SIR PHILIP SIDNEY

WILY CUPID

Trust not his wanton tears,
 Lest they beguile ye;
Trust not his childish sigh,
 He breatheth slily.
Trust not his touch,
 His feeling may defile ye;
Trust nothing that he doth,
 The wag is wily.
If you suffer him to prate,
You will rue it over-late.
 Beware of him, for he is witty:
Quickly strive the boy to bind,
Fear him not, for he is blind,
 If he get loose, he shows no pity.

HENRY CHETTLE.

THE BURIAL OF LOVE

*Maiden's hearts are always soft;
Would that men's were truer!*

SONG.

Two dark-eyed maids, at shut of day,
Sat where a river rolled away,
With calm, sad brows and raven hair,
And one was pale and both were fair.

Bring flowers, they sang, bring flowers unblown,
Bring forest-blooms of name unknown;
Bring budding sprays from wood and wild,
To strew the bier of Love, the child.

Close softly, fondly, while ye weep,
His eyes, that death may seem like sleep,
And fold his hands in sign of rest,
His waxen hands, across his breast.

And make his grave where violets hide,
Where star-flowers strew the rivulet's side,
And bluebirds in the misty spring
Of cloudless skies and summer sing.

Place near him, as ye lay him low,
His idle shafts, his loosened bow,
The silken fillet that around
His waggish eyes in sport he wound.

But we shall mourn him long, and miss
His ready smile, his ready kiss,
The patter of his little feet,
Sweet frowns and stammered phrases sweet;

And graver looks, serene and high,
A light of heaven in that young eye,
All these shall haunt us till the heart
Shall ache and ache—and tears will start.

The bow, the band shall fall to dust,
The mining arrows waste with rust,
And all of Love that earth can claim
Be but a memory and a name.

Not thus his nobler part shall dwell
A prisoner in this narrow cell;
But he whom now we hide from men
In the dark ground, shall live again:

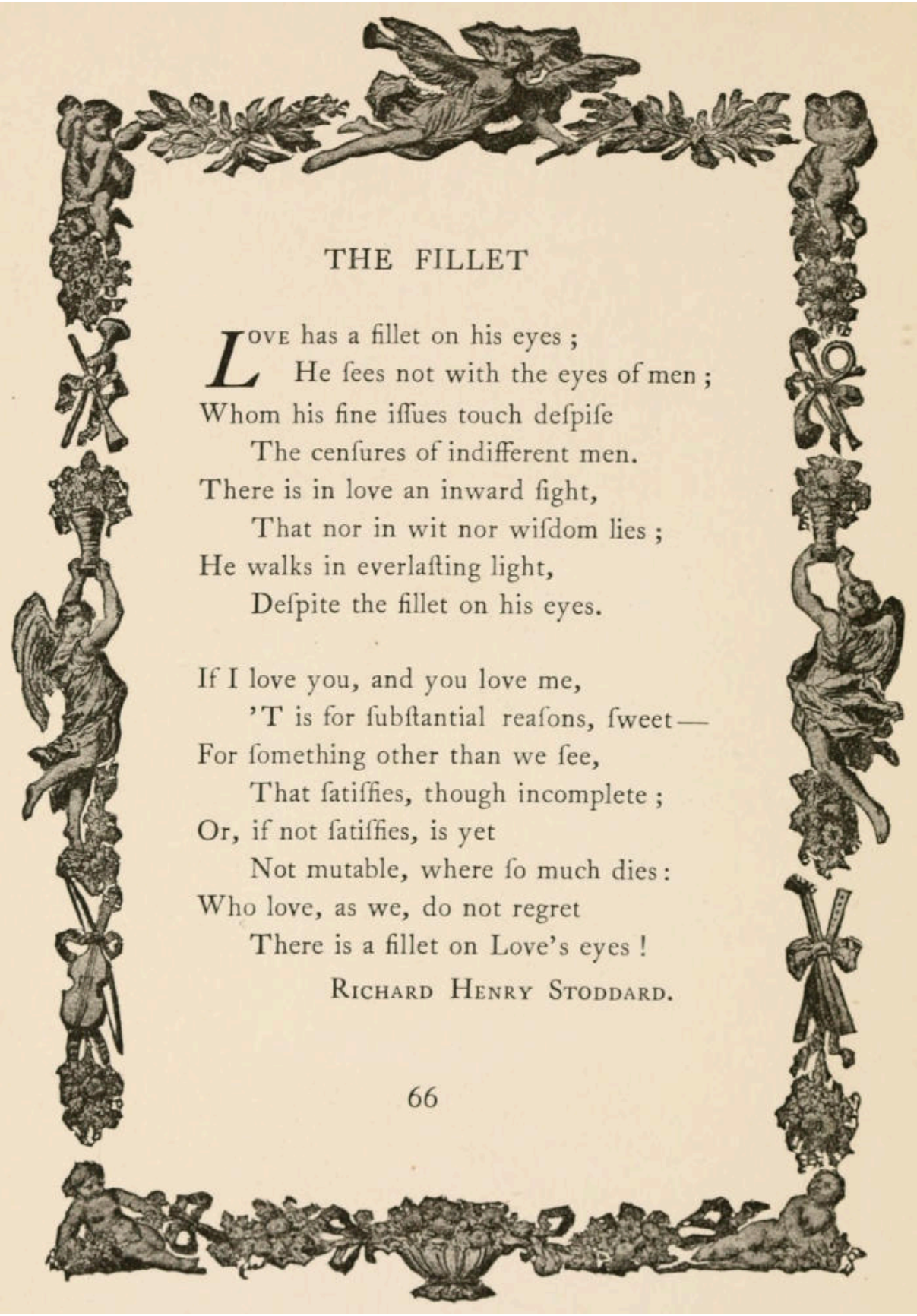
Shall break these clods, a form of light,
With nobler mien and purer sight,
And in the eternal glory stand,
Highest and nearest God's right hand.

WILLIAM CULLEN BRYANT.

CUPID SWALLOWED

T'other day, as I was twining
Roses, for a crown to dine in,
What, of all things, midst the heap,
Should I light on, fast asleep,
But the little desperate elf,
The tiny traitor—Love himself!
By the wings I pinch'd him up
Like a bee, and in a cup
Of my wine I plunged and sank him;
And what d'ye think I did?—I drank him!
Faith! I thought him dead. Not he!
There he lives with tenfold glee;
And now this moment, with his wings
I feel him tickling my heart-strings.

LEIGH HUNT.



THE FILLET

LOVE has a fillet on his eyes ;
He sees not with the eyes of men ;
Whom his fine issues touch despise
The censures of indifferent men.
There is in love an inward fight,
That nor in wit nor wisdom lies ;
He walks in everlasting light,
Despite the fillet on his eyes.

If I love you, and you love me,
'T is for substantial reasons, sweet —
For something other than we see,
That satisfies, though incomplete ;
Or, if not satisfies, is yet
Not mutable, where so much dies :
Who love, as we, do not regret
There is a fillet on Love's eyes !

RICHARD HENRY STODDARD.

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THE ARCHERY MATCH

She fits the arrow to its place,
She bends the bow with skill and grace,
 The feathered shaft lets fly;
A look of triumph lights her face—
 The score's a tie!

Dan Cupid, who's a bowman true,
Then boldly tries what he can do
 To bind the tie fore'er;
Result: the world declares the two
 A well-matched pair!

ARTHUR GRISSOM.

THE BURIAL OF LOVE

His eyes in eclipse,
 Pale-cold his lips,
The light of his hopes unfed,
 Mute his tongue,
 His bow unstrung
With the tears he hath shed,
Backward drooping his graceful head,
 Love is dead:
 His last arrow is sped;
 He hath not another dart;
Go—carry him to his dark deathbed;
 Bury him in the cold, cold heart—
 Love is dead.

Oh, truest Love! art thou forlorn,
 And unrevenged? thy pleasant wiles
 Forgotten, and thine innocent joy?
 Shall hollow-hearted Apathy,
The cruellest form of perfect scorn
 With languor of most hateful smiles,
 Forever write,
 In the withered light
 Of the tearless eye,
 An epitaph that all may spy?
 No! sooner she herself shall die.

For her the showers shall not fall
Nor the round sun shine that shineth to all;
 Her light shall into darkness change;
For her the green grass shall not spring,
Nor the rivers flow, nor the sweet birds sing,
 Till Love have his full revenge.

ALFRED, LORD TENNYSON.

SONG

Ladies, though to your conquering eyes
Love owes his chiefest victories,
And borrows those bright arms from you
With which he does the world subdue;
Yet you yourselves are not above
The empire nor the griefs of love.

Then rack not lovers with disdain,
Lest love on you revenge their pain;
You are not free because you're fair,
The boy did not his mother spare:
Though beauty be a killing dart,
It is no armour for the heart.

SIR GEORGE ETHEREGE.

LOVE AND MISCHIEF

One sunny day Love chose to stray
Adown a rosy path forbidden,
Where Mischief deep in ambush lay,
And watched his snare 'neath flowers hidden:
Love tumbling in, began to shout
For Mischief's aid, lest he should smother:
"You little demon, let me out,
Or I'll report you to my mother."
Said Mischief, "I'll not set you free
Unless you share your power with me,
And give of every heart you gain,
One-half to joy and half to pain."

Love struggled, but in vain, alas!
He was not born to prove a martyr,
And, sad to tell! it came to pass
He gave in to the little Tartar.
Love flew to Venus in a pet,
And cried, when he had told his story:
"O, Queen of Beauty, never let
That little imp wear half my glory."
The goddess with a look sedate,
Replied, "I cannot alter fate,
But you shall conquer still, my boy,
I'll make love's pain more sweet than joy."

ZAVARR WILMSHURST.

DAMON AND CUPID

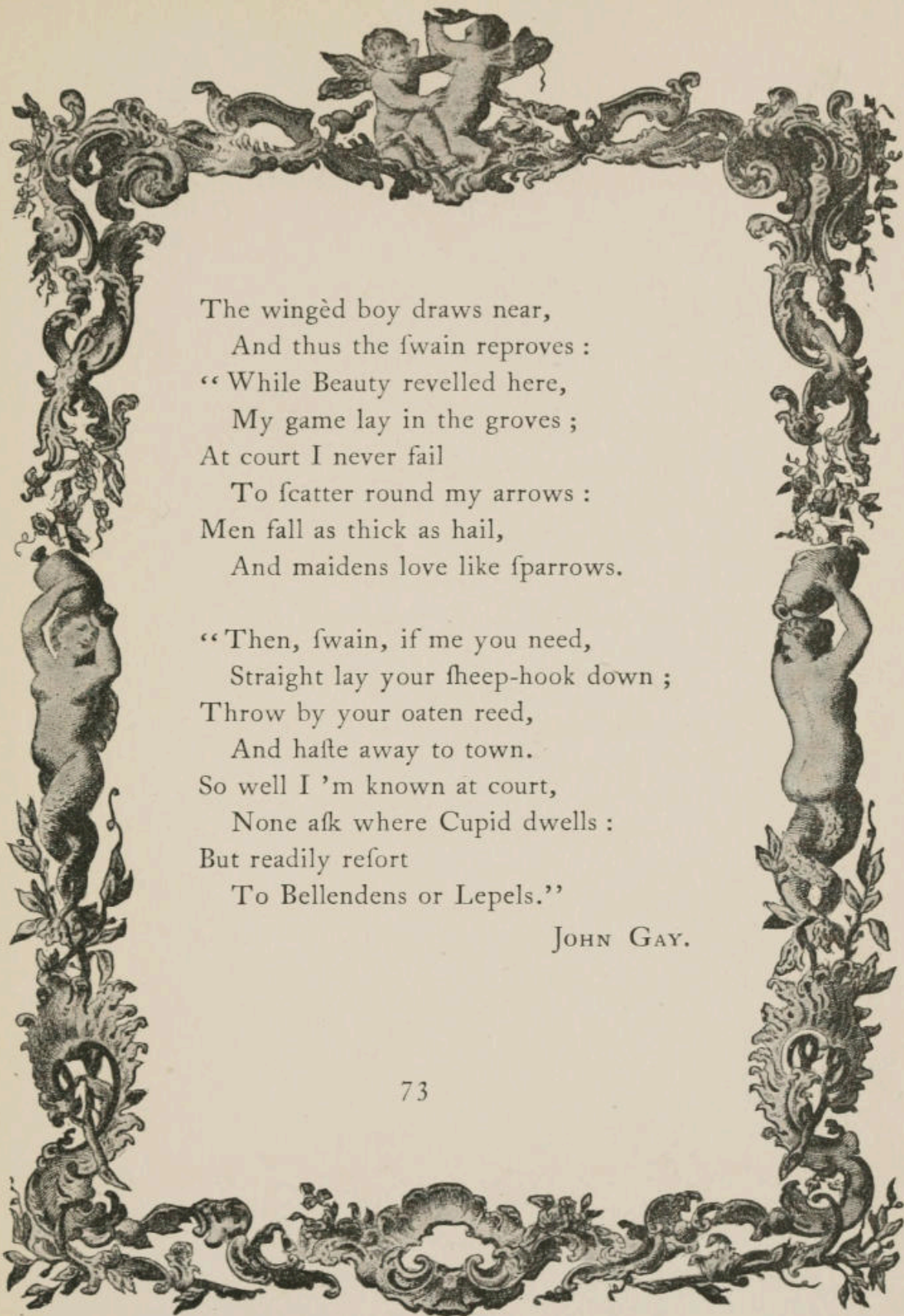
*T*HE sun was now withdrawn,
The shepherds home were sped ;
The moon wide o'er the lawn
Her silver mantle spread ;
When Damon stayed behind,
And fauntered in the grove :
“ Will ne'er a nymph be kind,
And give me love for love ?

“ O ! those were golden hours,
When Love, devoid of cares,
In all Arcadia's bowers
Lodged nymphs and swains by pairs ;
But now from wood and plain
Flies every sprightly lass ;
No joys for me remain,
In shades, or on the grass.”

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The wingèd boy draws near,
And thus the fwain reproves :
“ While Beauty revelled here,
My game lay in the groves ;
At court I never fail
To scatter round my arrows :
Men fall as thick as hail,
And maidens love like sparrows.

“ Then, fwain, if me you need,
Straight lay your sheep-hook down ;
Throw by your oaten reed,
And haste away to town.
So well I ’m known at court,
None ask where Cupid dwells :
But readily resort
To Bellendens or Lepels.”

JOHN GAY.

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CUPID AND CAMPASPE

Cupid and my Campaspe played
At cards for kisses; Cupid paid.
He stakes his quiver, bow and arrows,
His mother's doves and team of sparrows;
Loses them, too; then down he throws
The coral of his lip, the rose
Growing on 's cheek, but none knows how;
With these the crystal of his brow,
And then the dimple of his chin—
All these did my Campaspe win.
At last he set her both his eyes;
She won, and Cupid blind did rise.
O Love! has she done this to thee?
What shall, alas, become of me!

JOHN LYLY.

LOVE FOR LOVE

Away with these self-loving lads
Whom Cupid's arrow never glads!
Away poor souls that sigh and weep,
In love of those that lie asleep!
For Cupid is a meadow god,
And forceth none to kiss the rod.

Sweet Cupid's shafts, like destiny,
Do causeless good or ill decree;
Desert is borne out of his bow,
Reward upon his wing doth go!
What fools are they that have not known
That Love likes no laws but his own.

My songs they be of Cynthia's praise,
I wear her rings on holy-days,
In every tree I write her name,
And every day I read the same.
Where Honour Cupid's rival is,
There miracles are seen of his.

If Cynthia crave her ring of me,
I blot her name out of the tree;
If doubt do darken things held dear,
Then well-fare nothing, once a year;
For many run, but one must win,
Fools only hedge the cuckoo in.

The worth that worthiness should move,
Is Love, that is the bow of Love;
And love as well the foster can,
As can the mighty noble-man:—
Sweet saint, 'tis true, you worthy be,

Yet, without love, nought worth to me.

FULKE GREVILLE.

A KISS

You ask me what's a kiss?
 'Tis Cupid's keenest arrow!
A thing to take a "miss"—
(You ask me what's a kiss?)
The brink of an abyss!
 A lover's pathway, narrow.
You ask me what's a *kiss*?
 'Tis Cupid's *keenest* arrow!

CHARLES HENRY LÜDERS.

THE DILEMMA

Now, by the blessed Paphian queen,
Who heaves the breast of sweet sixteen;
By every name I cut on bark
Before my morning star grew dark;
By Hymen's torch, by Cupid's dart,
By all that thrills the beating heart;
The bright black eye, the melting blue—
I cannot choose between the two.

I had a vision in my dreams;—
I saw a row of twenty beams;
From every beam a rope was hung,
In every rope a lover swung;
I asked the hue of every eye
That bade each luckless lover die;
Ten shadowy lips said heavenly blue,
And ten accused the darker hue.

I asked a matron which she deemed
With fairest light of beauty beamed;
She answered, some thought both were fair—
Give her blue eyes and golden hair.
I might have liked her judgment well,
But, as she spoke, she rung the bell,
And all her girls, nor small nor few,
Came marching in—their eyes were blue.

I asked a maiden; back she flung
The locks that round her forehead hung,
And turned her eye, a glorious one,
Bright as a diamond in the sun,
On me, until beneath its rays
I felt as if my hair would blaze;

She liked all eyes but eyes of green;
She looked at me, what could she mean?

Ah! many lids Love lurks between,
Nor heeds the coloring of his screen;
And when his random arrows fly,
The victim falls, but knows not why.
Gaze not upon his shield of jet,
The shaft upon the firing is set;
Look not beneath his azure veil,
Though every limb was cased in mail.

Well both might make a martyr break
The chain that bound him to the stake;
And both with but a single ray
Can melt our very hearts away;
And both, when balanced, hardly seem
To stir the scales, or rock the beam;
But that is dearest, all the while,
That wears for us the sweetest smile.

OLIVER WENDELL HOLMES.

LOVE PENITENT

Paint me, Love, not, as of old,
Like a reveler overbold—
Roses dropping from his hair,
Wings that rise from either shoulder
Like a flame and fan the air—
Love is sadder grown and older,
Plays no more with bow and arrows,
Scarce has heart to feed his sparrows.

Paint him like a penitent,
Wan with keeping year-long Lent,
Worn with watching, faint with prayer,
Dust, not roses, in his hair.
Give him, for his bow and quiver,
At his belt a pair of beads;
If the cold air make him shiver,
Give him sackcloth for his needs.
Lingering farewells, merry meetings,
Stolen looks and fancy greetings,
Dance and song and revel gay,
He must put them all away.

Bid him with his naked feet
Trample out his torch's flame,
Turn from wine and dainty meat,
All his wandering fancies tame:
Only, lest we quite forget him—
We that used to spoil and pet him—
Grant him through his penance sad
But one gift his childhood had—
Neither torch nor shaft nor bow,
But the smile we used to know.

HENRY JOHNSTONE.



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